

An Expression A Day

AEAD PDF Book

No. 701-800 / 100 entries

Hilofumi Yamamoto, Ph.D.

Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC BY 4.0)

So that's what you mean?

そういうこと？

sou iu koto?

So that's what you mean?

Variants

- ということですか？

So that's what you mean?

- そういう意味い みですか？

Is that what you mean?

- ということなんですか？

Is that what you're saying?

Adjusted Expression

それは、そういう意味い みですか？

Is that what you mean?

Example

A 「この問題もんだいを解決かいけつするには、新あたしい方法ほうほうが必要ひつようだと思う」 B 「そういうこと？」 A 「うん、今いまのやり方かたじゃ、時間じかんがかかりすぎるからね」

A: I think we need a new method to solve this problem. B: So that's what you mean? A: Yes, because the current way takes too much time.

Notes

"So that's what you mean?" is used when the speaker takes up the listener's previous statement and checks whether their understanding is

correct. "Sou iu koto" receives the preceding statement as a whole and returns it to the listener as a summarized meaning. It does not simply ask about the meaning of a word. It checks the listener's intention or the main point of the explanation and helps organize the conversation. The short form "sou iu koto?" is casual, while "sou iu imi desu ka?" is more suitable in a formal situation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- checking one's understanding
- checking the listener's intention
- summarizing what was said
- organizing the conversation

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- confirmation expression
- expression of checking understanding
- echo-question expression
- conversation-organizing expression

Is that enough?

それで足りる？

sore de tariru?

Is that enough?

Variants

- それで足りますか？

Is that enough?

- それで十分ですか？

Is that sufficient?

- それで大丈夫ですか？

Will that be okay?

Adjusted Expression

それで足りますか？

Is that enough?

Example

A 「割り勘^{わ かん}でいい？」 B 「うん。じゃ、これ、私の分^{わたし ぶん}。それで足りる？」 A
「うん、ありがとう」

A: Is it okay to split the bill? B: Yes. Then this is my part. Is that enough?

A: Yes, thank you.

Notes

"Is that enough?" is used to check whether the amount, money, information, or other item just offered is sufficient. "Sore de" refers to what has already been shown or offered, and "tariru?" asks whether there is any shortage. The expression does more than check quantity. It also suggests that the speaker is prepared to add more if it is not enough. It is useful in situations involving shared payment, money, materials, time, explanations, or anything where a required amount matters.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

checking sufficiency

consideration for possible shortage

checking amount or quantity

confirmation with the listener

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

confirmation expression

expression of checking sufficiency

expression of considering possible shortage

expression of checking quantity

When you look at it overall, ...

とーたる かんが
トータルで考えると、...

tootaru de kangaeru to, ...

When you look at it overall, ...

Variants

- ぜんたい かんが
• 全体で考えると、...

When you look at it as a whole, ...

- そうごうてき かんが
• 総合的に考えると、...

When you think about it comprehensively, ...

- ぜんたいてき み
• 全体的に見ると、...

Overall, ...

Adjusted Expression

そうごうてき かんが
総合的に考えると、...

When considered comprehensively, ...

Example

こま もんだい
細かい問題はありましたが、とーたる かんが
このプロジェクトは成功
おも
だったと思います。

There were some small problems, but when you look at it overall, I think this project was a success.

Notes

"When you look at it overall" is used when the speaker moves from individual details or problems to an overall evaluation. "Tootaru de" means looking at the combined result, effect, cost, effort, or value, rather than judging each part separately. The expression is useful when summing up an evaluation, as in cases where there were problems but the whole result was good, or where the details were fine but the overall situation was difficult.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

presentation of an overall evaluation shift from details to the whole

introduction to a conclusion organization of evaluation criteria

Tags EN

immediate grammar spoken expression of overall evaluation

expression of sharing the overall picture conclusion-introducing expression

expression of organizing evaluation

This is the main thing right now, but...

いま め い ん
今は、これがメインなんですけど、...

ima wa, kore ga mein nan desu kedo, ...

This is the main thing right now, but...

Variants

- いま め い ん
● 今は、これがメインなんですが、...

This is the main thing right now, but...

- いま ちゅうしん
● 今は、これが中心なんですけど、...

This is the central thing right now, but...

- いま ちゅうしん
● 今は、これを中心にやっているんですけど、...

Right now, this is what I'm mainly working on, but...

Adjusted Expression

げんざい ちゅうしん すす
現在は、これを中心に進めています、...

At present, I am mainly working on this, but...

Example

いま め い ん しょうらい おお ぶろ じえ くと
今は、これがメインなんですけど、将来はもっと大きなプロジェクトをやりたいと思っています。

This is the main thing right now, but in the future, I want to work on a bigger project.

Notes

"This is the main thing right now, but..." presents the activity or object that is currently central while leaving open the possibility that the situation may change. "Ima wa" limits the statement to the present, and "kore ga mein" identifies the current focus. By ending with "nan desu kedo," the speaker leaves room for future development, another plan, or additional explanation. The expression does more than state the current topic. It serves as an entry into an explanation such as "this is the main thing for now, but it may develop later."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

presentation of the current main focus

explanation of one's current activity

introduction to future development

limiting the topic to the present

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

situation-explaining expression

topic-presenting expression

activity-explaining expression

expression introducing future development

By default, ...

で ふ お る と
デフォルトで、 ...

deforuto de, ...

By default, ...

Variants

- しょきせってい 初期設定では、 ...

By default, ...

- しょきじょうたい 初期状態では、 ...

In the default setting, ...

- つうじょう 通常は、 ...

Usually, ...

Adjusted Expression

しょきせってい
初期設定では、 ...になっています。

In the default setting, ... is enabled.

Example

で ふ お る と せってい ゆうこう
デフォルトで、 この設定は有効になっています。

By default, this setting is enabled.

Notes

"By default, ..." is used to explain the initial state or standard setting that applies when nothing has been changed. "Deforuto" is often used in explanations of computer or app settings, but it can also be used more

generally to refer to a state that applies automatically or is assumed from the beginning. It is similar to "usually," but "by default" specifically suggests an initial setting or built-in assumption.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- explanation of the initial state
- presentation of a setting assumption
- sharing of the unchanged state
- introduction to a technical explanation

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- explanation expression
- setting-explaining expression
- expression of default state
- technical explanation expression

On top of that, ...

ぷ ら す
プラスして、 ...

purasu shite, ...

On top of that, ...

Variants

- さらに^{くわ}えて、 ...
On top of that, ...
- それに^{くわ}えて、 ...
In addition, ...
- それに^{くわ}えてさらに、 ...
Furthermore, ...

Adjusted Expression

さらに^{くわ}えると、 ...

In addition, ...

Example

ぷ ら す き の う ゆ ー ー こ う ひ ょ う
プラスして、この機能はユーザーからも好評です。

On top of that, this feature has also been well received by users.

Notes

"On top of that, ..." is used when the speaker adds another piece of information, condition, or advantage to what has already been said.

"Purasu" does not simply list another item. It gives the sense of adding

something to strengthen the evaluation or explanation. With "shite," the speaker presents the added point and moves on to the next part of the explanation. The expression is useful in technical explanations, project descriptions, or work reports, but it has a somewhat business-like spoken flavor. In more formal writing, "sara ni kuwaeru to" or "sore ni kuwaete" is more natural.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- presentation of additional information
- adding to an evaluation or condition
- reinforcement of an explanation
- addition of another advantage

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- addition expression
- expression of reinforcing an explanation
- expression of adding to an evaluation
- business-like spoken expression

It was the opposite for me, but...

ぼく ぎゃく
僕は逆でしたけど、...

boku wa gyaku deshita kedo, ...

It was the opposite for me, but...

Variants

- わたし ぎゃく
• 私は逆でしたけど、...

It was the opposite for me, but...

- じぶん ぎゃく
• 自分は逆でしたけど、...

I had the opposite experience, but...

- ぼく ばあい ぎゃく
• 僕の場合は逆でしたけど、...

In my case, it was the opposite, but...

Adjusted Expression

わたし ばあい ぎゃく
私の場合は逆でしたが、...

In my case, it was the opposite, but...

Example

A 「この方法、最初は難しいけど、あとで楽になるよね」 B 「僕は逆でしたけど、人によるのかもしれませんがね」

A: This method is hard at first, but it gets easier later, doesn't it? B: It was the opposite for me, but maybe it depends on the person.

Notes

"It was the opposite for me, but..." is used when the speaker gently indicates that their own experience was opposite to what the listener said or to a general explanation. "Gyaku deshita" can refer to a result, impression, order, or feeling that went in the opposite direction. By ending with "kedo," the speaker avoids fully rejecting the listener's explanation and presents their own case as a separate example. The expression therefore works not as a strong objection, but as a contrast based on personal experience or as the presentation of another possibility.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

presentation of one's own experience contrast with a general view

softening of disagreement presentation of another possibility

Tags EN

immediate grammar spoken expression of presenting experience contrast expression

expression of softening disagreement expression of presenting another possibility

I clean on weekends.

しゅうまつ そうじ
週末、掃除してる。

shuumatsu, souji shiteru.

I clean on weekends.

Variants

- しゅうまつ そうじ
● 週末は掃除してる。

I clean on weekends.

- しゅうまつ そうじ
● 週末に掃除してる。

I do the cleaning on weekends.

- しゅうまつ そうじ
● 週末はだいたい掃除してる。

I usually clean on weekends.

Adjusted Expression

しゅうまつ そうじ
週末は掃除をしています。

I clean on weekends.

Example

A 「やすみの日って、何してるの？」 B 「しゅうまつ そうじ
週末、掃除してる。たまと大変だから」

A: What do you do on your days off? B: I clean on weekends. It gets hard if I let it pile up.

Notes

"I clean on weekends" briefly presents a habit or recent routine. By placing "shuumatsu" first, the speaker sets the time frame and then gives the activity with "souji shiteru." "Shiteru" is a casual form of "shite iru," and here it sounds like a regular habit rather than a single action happening right now. "Shuumatsu wa souji shiteru" more clearly presents cleaning as part of how the speaker spends weekends, while "shuumatsu ni souji shiteru" more strongly marks the time when the cleaning is done.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

explanation of a habit

sharing of how one spends weekends

presentation of an activity

explanation of recent life

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

habit expression

time expression

activity-explaining expression

recent-life explanation expression

On the way home, I happened to...

かえ とちゅう ぐうぜん
帰る途中でね、偶然、...

kaeru tochuu de ne, guuzen, ...

On the way home, I happened to...

Variants

- かえ とちゅう ぐうぜん
• 帰る途中で、偶然、...

On the way home, I happened to...

- かえ とちゅう ぐうぜん
• 帰る途中にね、偶然、...

While I was on my way home, I happened to...

- かえ ぐうぜん
• 帰ろうとしてたらね、偶然、...

When I was about to go home, I happened to...

Adjusted Expression

かえ とちゅう ぐうぜん
帰る途中で、偶然、...

On the way home, I happened to...

Example

かえ とちゅう ぐうぜん みせ み
帰る途中でね、偶然、この店を見つけたんだ。

On the way home, I happened to find this store.

Notes

"On the way home, I happened to..." is used when the speaker begins to tell a personal experience by first setting the scene and then introducing an accidental event. "Kaeru tochuu de" gives the temporal or movement-

based setting in which the event occurred, and "ne" draws the listener into the story. "Guuzen" presents the event as something that happened by chance, not as something planned. The expression does more than state a fact. It works as a narrative opening that hands the experience to the listener, with a feeling like "listen to this."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- opening a personal experience
- introduction of an accidental event
- handoff to the listener
- setting the situation

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- expression of sharing experience
- expression of coincidence
- narrative-opening expression
- situation-setting expression

We can leave now.

もう^{しゅっぱつ}出発できるよ。

mou shuppatsu dekiru yo.

We can leave now.

Variants

- もう^い行けるよ。

We can go now.

- もう^{しゅっぱつ}出発できますよ。

We can leave now.

- もう^{しゅっぱつ}出発できると^{おも}います。

I think we can leave now.

Adjusted Expression

もう^{しゅっぱつ}出発できます。

We can leave now.

Example

もう^{しゅっぱつ}出発できるよ。^{じゅんび}準備、できてる？

We can leave now. Are you ready?

Notes

"We can leave now" tells the listener that the preparations are complete and that it is now possible to depart. "Mou" marks the shift from waiting or preparing to being ready to leave. "Shuppatsu dekiru" here does not

mainly express ability, but rather that the conditions are now in place. With "yo," the speaker hands this information to the listener and signals a move to the next action. The expression therefore does more than describe the situation. It can also imply "Let's get going" or "Get ready."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- conveying readiness
- signal to move to the next action
- sharing that departure is possible
- prompting the listener

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- readiness expression
- expression of starting an action
- situation-sharing expression
- prompting expression

For now, ...

いま
今のところ、...

ima no tokoro, ...

For now, ...

Variants

- ^{げんじてん}現時点では、...

For now, ...

- とりあえず、...

At this point, ...

- ^{いま}今の^{だんかい}段階では、...

At this stage, ...

Adjusted Expression

^{げんじてん}
現時点では、...

At this point, ...

Example

^{いま}今のところ、この^{ほうほう}方法が^{さいてき}最適だと^{おも}思います。

For now, I think this method is the best.

Notes

"For now, ..." is used when the speaker states a situation or judgment based on what is currently known. By saying "ima no tokoro," the speaker leaves room for the judgment to change later if new information

or circumstances appear. It is close to "at this point," but sounds a little more conversational. Compared with "toriaezu," it sounds less like a temporary stopgap and more like a calm judgment at the current stage.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- explanation of the current situation
- presentation of a provisional judgment
- leaving room for future change
- evaluation at the present point

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- situation-explaining expression
- provisional judgment expression
- present-point evaluation expression
- expression of leaving room for change

To get straight to the point, ...

けつろん い
結論から言うと、...

ketsuron kara iu to, ...

To get straight to the point, ...

Variants

- ようてん い
要点から言うと、...

To get straight to the point, ...

- けつろん さき い
結論を先に言うと、...

To give you the bottom line, ...

- さき けつろん い
先に結論を言うと、...

To state the conclusion first, ...

Adjusted Expression

けつろん さき もう
結論を先に申しますと、...

To state the conclusion first, ...

Example

けつろん い ほうほう もっと こうかてき
結論から言うと、この方法が最も効果的だということがわかりました。

To get straight to the point, we found that this method is the most effective.

Notes

"To get straight to the point, ..." is used when the speaker gives the conclusion or key point before going into the details. It changes the order

of explanation from "background to conclusion" to "conclusion to explanation." This lets the listener know the direction of the talk first and makes the following explanation easier to understand. The expression is useful in meetings, reports, consultations, and research explanations when the speaker wants to avoid being roundabout and begin with the main point.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- stating the conclusion first
- organizing the order of explanation
- reducing the listener's processing burden
- introduction to the key point

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- conclusion-marking expression
- explanation-organizing expression
- key-point-introducing expression
- expression of reducing processing burden

Honestly, I'm really stuck.

ほんと、まいったよ。

honto, maitta yo.

Honestly, I'm really stuck.

Variants

- ^{ほんとう} 本当、まいったよ。
Honestly, I'm really stuck.
- ^{しょうじき} 正直、まいったよ。
To be honest, I'm at a loss.
- いや、ほんと、まいったよ。
This really got me.

Adjusted Expression

^{ほんとう} 本当に、^{こま} 困ってしまいました。

I am really at a loss.

Example

ほんと、まいったよ。この^{もんだい}問題、どうやって^{かいけつ}解決すればいいのか、わからないんだ。

Honestly, I'm really stuck. I don't know how to solve this problem.

Notes

"Honestly, I'm really stuck" is used when the speaker is in a difficult situation and lets the listener know that they do not know what to do.

"Honto" is not just emphasis. It presents the speaker's genuine feeling.

"Maitta" includes the sense of being troubled, defeated, or at a loss, and it sounds stronger than simple confusion. With "yo," the speaker hands that feeling to the listener, as if asking them to receive it.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of being troubled
- sharing of being stuck
- presentation of vulnerability
- handoff to the listener

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- emotion expression
- expression of confusion
- expression of being stuck
- expression of vulnerability

Oh, I didn't know that.

ああ、^し知らなかった。

aa, shiranakatta.

Oh, I didn't know that.

Variants

- ああ、それは^し知らなかった。

Oh, I didn't know that.

- ああ、そうだったんだ。

Oh, so that was the case.

- ああ、それは^{はつみみ}初耳。

Oh, that's news to me.

Adjusted Expression

ああ、それは^し知りませんでした。

Oh, I wasn't aware of that.

Example

A 「この^{みせ}店、^{こんげつ}今月で^{へいてん}閉店するらしいよ」 B 「ああ、^し知らなかった。それは^{はつみみ}初耳」

A: I heard this shop is closing this month. B: Oh, I didn't know that. That's news to me.

Notes

"Oh, I didn't know that" is used when the speaker receives information from the listener and indicates that they had not known it before. "Aa" gives the feeling of noticing or mild surprise at the moment the information is received. "Shiranakatta" is not only a statement that the speaker lacked the knowledge. It also works conversationally as "I understand it now because you told me." The expression accepts the listener's explanation and can open the way for the conversation to continue. Adding "that's news to me" makes the sense of hearing it for the first time stronger.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

receiving new information

expression of not having known

expression of mild surprise

response to the listener's explanation

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

response expression

expression of receiving new information

expression of mild surprise

expression of understanding

Don't worry about it.

き
気にしないで。

ki ni shinaide.

Don't worry about it.

Variants

- き
気にしないでください。

Don't worry about it.

- き
気にしないでね。

Please don't worry about it.

- ぜんぜん き
全然気にしなくていいよ。

You don't need to worry about it at all.

Adjusted Expression

どうぞおきになさらないでください。

Please do not worry about it.

Example

A 「ごめん、おそ遅くなって」 B 「大丈夫、だいじょうぶ き気にしないで」

A: Sorry I'm late. B: It's okay. Don't worry about it.

Notes

"Don't worry about it" is used when the listener has apologized, feels anxious, or is holding back, and the speaker wants to tell them that the matter does not need to be treated as a problem any further. "Ki ni suru"

means to keep something on one's mind, and "ki ni shinaide" encourages the listener to let go of that concern. As a response to an apology, it reassures the listener by suggesting that the matter is not serious and that the speaker is not blaming them. Because it is short, it works as an immediate expression for lowering the listener's burden in everyday conversation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of reassurance
- reduction of the listener's burden
- response to an apology
- receiving anxiety or hesitation

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- reassurance expression
- response to an apology
- expression of reducing burden
- comfort expression

I'll think about it.

かんが
考えとく。

kangae toku.

I'll think about it.

Variants

- かんが
• 考えておきます。

I'll think about it.

- かんが
• 考えておくね。

I'll consider it.

- かんが
• ちょっと考えとく。

I'll keep it in mind.

Adjusted Expression

かんが
考えておきます。

I'll think about it.

Example

A 「来週、木曜、来てくれる？」 B 「うん、ちょっと考えとくね」

A: Can you come next Thursday? B: Yeah, I'll think about it.

Notes

"I'll think about it" is used when the speaker does not answer immediately and instead defers the response by saying that they will think about it later. "Kangae toku" is a casual form of "kangaete oku," and

literally means to think about something in preparation for a later decision. In conversation, however, it does not always promise serious or positive consideration. It can also be used simply to avoid giving an immediate answer. The expression lets the speaker receive the listener's invitation, request, or proposal without rejecting it on the spot, while postponing the judgment. Depending on the situation, it may sound close to a soft refusal.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- deferral of a response
- presentation of willingness to consider
- avoidance of an immediate answer
- possible soft refusal

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- deferral expression
- consideration expression
- expression of avoiding an immediate answer
- soft refusal expression

How did you do it?

どうやったの？

dou yatta no?

How did you do it?

Variants

- どうやってやったの？

How did you do it?

- どうやってそれをしたの？

How did you manage to do that?

- どうやってできたの？

How were you able to do it?

Adjusted Expression

どのようにしてやったのですか？

How did you do it?

Example

A 「このプロジェクト、成功せいこうさせたの、すごいね。どうやったの？」 B 「ありがとう。まあ、大たいしたことはしてないんだけどね」

A: It's amazing that you made this project a success. How did you do it? B: Thanks. Well, I didn't do anything special.

Notes

"How did you do it?" is used when the listener has accomplished something, solved a problem, or made something happen, and the

speaker wants to know the method or process. "Dou" asks about the method, and "yatta no?" takes up what the listener did and asks how it was done. It is not only a request for procedural information. It can also carry surprise or interest, as in "That's impressive" or "I want to know how you managed it." The expression works as an immediate question that draws out the listener's experience and keeps the conversation going.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- question about method
- surprise at an achievement
- interest in the process
- response to the listener's experience

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- expression of asking about method
- expression of surprise
- expression of checking the process
- response to experience

Want to go for lunch?

らんち、行かない？

ranchi, ikanai?

Want to go for lunch?

Variants

- らんち、食べに行かない？

Want to go for lunch?

- らんちに行かない？

Do you want to go for lunch?

- ちゅうしょく、い昼食に行きませんか？

Would you like to go for lunch?

Adjusted Expression

らんちに行きませんか？

Would you like to go for lunch?

Example

A 「お腹すいたね。らんち、行かない？」 B 「うん、いいね」

A: I'm hungry. Want to go for lunch? B: Yeah, sounds good.

Notes

"Want to go for lunch?" is a casual expression used to invite the listener to lunch. By placing "ranchi" first, the speaker first presents the meal as the topic, and then invites the listener with "ikanai?" If the speaker says

"ranchi ni ikanai?," lunch is explicitly marked as the destination or purpose. In "ranchi, ikanai?," the particle is left unexpressed, so the topic and the invitation connect more lightly. The expression is useful when casually asking someone familiar whether they want to go eat together now.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of invitation
- invitation to a meal
- checking the listener's availability
- suggestion to do something together

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- invitation expression
- expression of sharing a meal
- expression with an unexpressed particle
- expression of suggesting joint action

I knew it...

やっぱりい...

yapparii...

I knew it...

Variants

- やっぱり...

I knew it...

- やっぱりね...

Just as I thought...

- やはり...

As expected...

Adjusted Expression

やはりそうでしたか。

So it was as I thought.

Example

A 「冷蔵庫のアイスクリーム、食べたの、お父さん？」 B 「うん、そうだけ
ど...」 A 「やっぱりい...」

A: Dad, did you eat the ice cream in the fridge? B: Yeah, I did... A: I knew
it...

Notes

"I knew it..." is used at the moment when something the speaker
suspected or expected turns out to be true. "Yappari" connects the newly

confirmed fact with the speaker's prior expectation or feeling. The elongated final "i" represents a stretched voice and emotional coloring, giving a sense of mild exasperation, disappointment, or recognition. This way of saying it sounds natural as a child's reaction, but adults also use it in familiar situations. When adults use it, the slightly childlike tone can soften the blame and express mild exasperation or teasing in a light way.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- response to something turning out as expected
- recognition of the listener's action
- expression of mild exasperation
- sharing of recognition mixed with disappointment

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- response expression
- expression of something being as expected
- expression of mild exasperation
- emotional spelling

Can I try it?

やってみていい？

yatte mite ii?

Can I try it?

Variants

- やっててもいい？
Can I try it?
- やっててもいいですか？
Is it okay if I try it?
- ^{ため}試してみてもいい？
Can I give it a try?

Adjusted Expression

やっててもいいですか？

Is it okay if I try it?

Example

A 「このゲーム、面白そうだね。やってみていい？」 B 「うん、いいよ」

A: This game looks fun. Can I try it? B: Yeah, go ahead.

Notes

"Can I try it?" is used when the speaker wants to check whether they may try something that belongs to the listener, is being used by the listener, or is part of a shared situation. "Yatte miru" means to try doing something when the result is not yet known, and "ii?" asks for the listener's

permission. The expression does not simply say that the speaker wants to do it. It checks whether the speaker may enter the listener's object, task, or situation. It is therefore useful as an immediate check before trying a game, tool, operation, method, or similar action.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- checking permission
- presenting the wish to try
- consideration for the listener's object or space
- checking before starting an action

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- permission-checking expression
- trial expression
- action-starting expression
- consideration expression

In any case,

なにはともあれ、

nani wa tomo are,

In any case,

Variants

- なにはともあれ、
In any case,
- とにかく、
Anyway,
- いずれにしても、
At any rate,

Adjusted Expression

いずれにいたしましても、

In any case,

Example

なにはともあれ、^{けんこう}健康が^{だいいち}第一だよね。

In any case, health comes first, doesn't it?

Notes

"In any case" is used when the speaker sets aside various circumstances or details and brings out what matters first. "Nani" broadly takes in surrounding matters or other possibilities, and "tomo are" sets them aside for the moment. The expression therefore does not simply change

the topic. It organizes a complicated situation and presents the main point or priority. In everyday conversation, it is close to "anyway" or "at any rate," but "nani wa tomo are" sounds a little more settled and summarizing.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- presentation of priority
- summing up the talk
- shift from details to the main point
- introduction to a conclusion

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- topic-organizing expression
- key-point-presenting expression
- expression of presenting priority
- conclusion-introducing expression

Then, you see,

そうするとですね、

sou suru to desu ne,

Then, you see,

Variants

- そうすると、
Then,
- そうするとですね、
Then, you see,
- そうすると、つまり、
If that is the case, then...

Adjusted Expression

そうすると、

Then,

Example

A 「この条件^{じょうけん}を先^{さき}に決める^きんですね」 B 「そうするとですね、次^{つぎ}に必要な^{ひつよう}作業^{さぎょう}が見^みえてきます」

A: So we decide this condition first, right? B: Then, you see, the next necessary task becomes clear.

Notes

"Then, you see," is used when the speaker takes up the previous condition, operation, or explanation and moves to the result or next

development. "Sou suru to" creates a connection meaning "if we do that" or "if we think on that basis." "Desu ne" is not merely a request for agreement. It draws the listener into the flow of the explanation and gives the speaker a small pause before moving on. The expression is often used in lectures, explanations, consultations, or procedural explanations when moving from the previous step to the next result.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

development of an explanation

connection from the previous content to the next step

introduction of a result

drawing the listener into the explanation

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

explanation-developing expression

connecting expression

result-introducing expression

listener-involving expression

I really don't want to.

いやだなあ。

iya da naa.

I really don't want to.

Variants

- いやだなあ。

I really don't want to.

- いやだな。

I'm not looking forward to it.

- ああ、いやだなあ。

I don't like this.

Adjusted Expression

それは少し気が重いですね。

I am not looking forward to that.

Example

A 「明日、^{あした}試験^{しけん}だよ」 B 「そうなんだよ、いやだなあ」

A: The exam is tomorrow, right? B: Yeah, I know. I'm not looking forward to it.

Notes

"I really don't want to" is used when the speaker lets out a feeling of dislike, reluctance, or heaviness toward something that is coming up or cannot easily be avoided. "Iya da" expresses dislike or refusal, but "naa"

makes it sound less like a direct rejection and more like a sigh coming from the speaker's own feeling. The expression is therefore not mainly used to oppose the listener directly. It is often used before an exam, a troublesome task, or an awkward plan, when the speaker shares a bit of their reluctance with the listener.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of dislike
- sharing of heaviness or reluctance
- presentation of wanting to avoid something
- mild expression of dissatisfaction

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- emotion expression
- expression of dislike
- expression of reluctance
- dissatisfaction expression

Oh, no way...

ええ、そんなあ...

ee, sonnaa...

Oh, no way...

Variants

- ええ、そんなあ...
Oh, no way...
- ええ、そんな...
Oh, that's not fair...
- ええ、そんなの...
Oh, come on...

Adjusted Expression

ええ、それは少し困ります。

Well, that would be a bit difficult for me.

Example

A 「この^{しはら}支払い、よろしく」 B 「ええ、そんなあ...」

A: You're paying for this one. B: Oh, no way...

Notes

"Oh, no way..." is used when the listener says something unexpected and the speaker cannot immediately accept it. "Ee" expresses surprise or bewilderment, and "sonna" takes up the listener's whole statement, creating a feeling like "How can you say that?" or "You can't mean that."

The elongated final "aa" softly expresses trouble, reluctance, or mild protest. Before making a clear refusal, the speaker first hands the emotional reaction to the listener.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- response to an unexpected demand
- expression of difficulty accepting something
- mild protest
- sharing of bewilderment

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- response expression
- surprise expression
- expression of mild protest
- emotional spelling

Okay, let's do it this way.

じゃ、こうしよう。

ja, kou shiyou.

Okay, let's do it this way.

Variants

- じゃ、こうしよう。
Okay, let's do it this way.
- じゃ、これでいこう。
Okay, let's go with this.
- じゃ、こういうふうにしよう。
Then let's do it like this.

Adjusted Expression

では、このようにしましょう。

Then, let us do it this way.

Example

A 「この問題、どう解決する？」 B 「じゃ、こうしよう。まずは原因を調査してみ、それから対策を考えよう」

A: How should we solve this problem? B: Okay, let's do it this way. First, let's investigate the cause, and then think about countermeasures.

Notes

"Okay, let's do it this way" is used after a discussion, hesitation, or uncertainty, when the speaker presents one way to proceed. "Ja" takes up

the previous statement or situation and signals a move to the next step, roughly like "then" or "in that case." "Kou shiyou" proposes that the speakers follow the method being introduced or shown. The expression therefore does more than offer a casual idea. It organizes the conversation and moves it toward the next action. It is natural in familiar situations, but it also places the speaker slightly in the role of organizing the situation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- proposal of how to proceed
- shift toward a decision
- organization of a stalled discussion
- presentation of the next action

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- suggestion expression
- expression of moving toward a decision
- action-presenting expression
- discussion-organizing expression

That's good to hear.

それはなにより。

sore wa nani yori.

That's good to hear.

Variants

- それはなにより。
That's good to hear.
- それはよかった。
That's a relief.
- それは^{なに}何よりです。
I'm glad to hear that.

Adjusted Expression

それはよかったですね。

That is good to hear.

Example

A 「^{びょうき}病気、もう^{なお}治ったよ」 B 「それはなにより。」

A: I've recovered from my illness. B: That's good to hear.

Notes

"That's good to hear" is used when the speaker hears that the listener's situation has improved or that something worrying has ended safely.

"Sore wa" takes up the good news the listener has just given. "Nani yori" suggests that this outcome matters more than anything else. Compared

with a simple "That's good," the expression sounds like the speaker is quietly relieved or glad about the listener's safety or good result. It has a slightly settled or polite tone, and can be used both in familiar conversation and as a gentle, respectful response.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of relief
- receiving a good outcome
- empathy toward the listener
- expression of gladness that things went well

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- relief expression
- empathy expression
- expression of receiving a good outcome
- expression of confirming that things went well

What did you just say?

いま なん い
今、何て言った？

ima, nan te itta?

What did you just say?

Variants

- いま なん い
● 今、何て言った？

What did you just say?

- いま なん い
● 今、何て言いました？

What was that you just said?

- いま なん
● 今、何て？

What did you say just now?

Adjusted Expression

いま なん
今、何とおっしゃいましたか？

What did you just say?

Example

A 「この映画、面白かった！」 B 「いま なん い ほんとう おも
今、何て言った？ 本当にそう思うの？」

A: This movie was really good! B: What did you just say? Do you really think so?

Notes

"What did you just say?" is used to ask about what the listener has just said. "Ima" marks the utterance as something that occurred just now, and

"nan te itta?" asks for its content. However, the expression is not only a request to repeat something that was not heard clearly. It can also be used when the listener's remark was surprising, hard to believe, or difficult to let pass. In that case, it means less "Please repeat that" and more "Did you really just say that?" Depending on the tone of voice, it can be a simple confirmation or a strong immediate reaction.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- checking the immediately preceding utterance
- response of surprise
- response to a remark that cannot be ignored
- questioning the listener back

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- confirmation expression
- surprise expression
- echo-question expression
- expression that can easily sound challenging

I'd like you to..., but...

...てほしいんですけど、

... te hoshii n desu kedo,

I'd like you to..., but...

Variants

- ...てほしいんですけど、
I'd like you to..., but...
- ...してほしいんですが、
I was wondering if you could...
- ...てもらいたいんですけど、
I'd like to ask you to...

Adjusted Expression

...ていただきたいのですが、

I would like to ask you to..., but...

Example

A 「これ、^{てっだ}手伝ってほしいんですけど」 B 「^{いま}今、^{いそが}ちょっと忙しいんで、^{あと}後でいいですか？」

A: I'd like you to help me with this, but... B: I'm a bit busy right now.
Would later be okay?

Notes

"I'd like you to..., but..." is used when the speaker wants the listener to do something and opens the request softly. "... te hoshii" shows that the

speaker wants the listener's action, but ending with "n desu kedo" avoids making the request fully direct and leaves room for the listener to accept, refuse, or give conditions. The expression therefore works not as a command or direct demand, but as a way to advance the request while watching the listener's response. In conversation, it may be followed by a more specific explanation or reason, or the speaker may simply wait for the listener's response.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- opening a request
- requesting an action from the listener
- request without direct assertion
- leaving room for the listener's response

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- request expression
- request-introducing expression
- unfinished expression
- expression of consideration for the listener

What do you call that?

それって何^{なん}て言^いうの？

sore tte nan te iu no?

What do you call that?

Variants

- それって何^{なん}て言^いうの？

What do you call that?

- それは何^{なん}と何^よ呼ばれているの？

What is that called?

- そうい^{なん}うの^いって、何て言^いうの？

What do you call that kind of thing?

Adjusted Expression

それは何^{なん}と何^よ呼ばれているのですか？

What is that called?

Example

きのう、^{かいてんまえ}開店前、^{みせ}店の前^{まえ}にみんな並^{なら}んで、それって何^{なん}て言^いうの？^{いちばんの}一番乗りっ
ていうの？^{ぎょうれつ}すごい行^{おどろ}列でね、驚いたよ。

Yesterday, before the store opened, there were people lined up in front of the store, and I was like, what do you call that? Is it called being first in line? It was such a long line that I was surprised.

Notes

"What do you call that?" is used when the speaker does not know the name of an object, situation, action, or concept, or when the speaker is not confident about the right term. "Sore tte" takes up something just mentioned or something in the current situation as the topic. "Nan te iu no?" asks the listener for the proper name or natural way to refer to it. The important point is that the speaker does not stop the conversation just because a word is missing. Instead, the speaker brings that uncertainty into the conversation and keeps going. This is not only a strategy for learners of Japanese. Native speakers also commonly use it as a word-search expression.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

asking for a name

word search

expression for keeping the conversation going

checking the term with the listener

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

word-search expression

name-checking expression

conversation strategy

expression for using vocabulary before it is settled

That's what I wanted to say.

それが言^いいたかった。

sore ga iitakatta.

That's what I wanted to say.

Variants

- それが言^いいたかった。

That's what I wanted to say.

- それを言^いいたかった。

That's what I meant to say.

- そう、それが言^いいたかったんだよ。

Yes, that's exactly what I wanted to say.

Adjusted Expression

まさにそれが言^いいたかったのです。

That is exactly what I wanted to say.

Example

A 「あのレ^れス^すト^とラン^{らん}、味^{あじ}はいいし、値^ね段^{だん}も手^て頃^{ごろ}で、すばらしいんだけど、どこかひとつ、ええと、何^{なん}だろ、何^{なん}て言^いったらいいいんだろう...」 B 「要^{よう}するに、雑^{ざつ}なんだね」 A 「うん、それが言^いいたかったんだよ！ 雑^{ざつ}、あのレ^れス^すト^とラン^{らん}！」

A: That restaurant has good food and reasonable prices, and it's great, but there is one thing, um, I don't know how to put it... B: So, basically, it feels sloppy, right? A: Yes, that's what I wanted to say! Sloppy, that restaurant!

Notes

"That's what I wanted to say" is used when the speaker was trying to express something but could not find the right wording, and the listener supplies an expression that fits. "Sore" takes up the expression or summary just given by the listener. "Iitakatta" shows that the speaker had something they wanted to say, but had not yet been able to verbalize it well. The expression is therefore not just agreement. It is a reaction in which the speaker's intended meaning is recovered through the listener's words. It is used when a word search is completed by the other person's utterance.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

agreement with someone else's wording

recovery of verbalization

receiving the listener's expression

completion of word search

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

proxy-expression

agreement expression

word-search expression

expression of recovering verbalization

Ah, so this is all I need to do.

あ、これでいいんだあ。

a, kore de ii n daa.

Ah, so this is all I need to do.

Variants

- あ、これでいいんだあ。
Ah, so this is all I need to do.
- あ、こうすればいいんだあ。
Ah, so this is how I should do it.
- あ、これでよかったんだ。
Ah, so this was okay after all.

Adjusted Expression

あ、これでよいのですね。

Ah, so this is acceptable.

Example

もんだい かいけつ ほうほう いろいろな しこうさくご
問題を解決する方法がわからなくて、いろいろ試行錯誤してたんだけど、あ、
これでいいんだあって気づいたよ。

I didn't know how to solve the problem and was trying various things,
but then I realized, ah, so this is all I need to do.

Notes

"Ah, so this is all I need to do" is used at the moment when the speaker suddenly realizes the right method or the sufficient state after trying

different things. "A" marks the rise of noticing, and "kore de ii" shows that this method, this state, or this degree is enough. "N daa" gives the feeling that the understanding has formed inside the speaker, rather than being merely explained from outside. The expression therefore carries not only discovery, but also relief or realization, as in "I was making it harder than it needed to be, but this was enough."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of discovery
- emergence of procedural understanding
- recovery from trial and error
- sharing of realization

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- discovery expression
- expression of understanding
- expression of recovering from trial and error
- realization expression

You're talking as if you can do it, but...

さもできるようなことを^い言ってるけど、

samo dekiru you na koto o itteru kedo,

You're talking as if you can do it, but...

Variants

- さもできるようなことを^い言ってるけど、
You're talking as if you can do it, but...
- さもできそうなことを^い言ってるけど、
You're making it sound like you can do it, but...
- さもわかってるようなことを^い言ってるけど、
You're talking as if you understand it, but...

Adjusted Expression

できるかのようなことをおっしゃっていますが、

You are speaking as if you could do it, but...

Example

A 「この作業、^{さぎょう} 一人^{ひとり}でできるって^い言ってたよ」 B 「さもできるようなことを^い言ってるけど、^{ほんとう} 本当^{だいじょうぶ}に大丈夫なのかな」

A: He said he could do this work by himself. B: He's talking as if he can do it, but I wonder if he'll really be okay.

Notes

"You're talking as if you can do it, but..." is used when the speaker expresses doubt or mild sarcasm toward someone who is speaking as if they are capable of doing something. "Samo" creates the sense that something is being presented as if it were true, even though it may not be. "Dekiru you na koto o itteru" suggests that the person's words make it sound possible, but the speaker doubts whether their actual ability or the situation really supports it. By ending with "kedo," the expression leaves room for a following judgment such as "Will it really be okay?" or "Maybe they actually can't do it."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

doubt about the listener's statement

criticism of pretending to be capable

pointing out a gap between words and ability

mild sarcasm

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

expression of doubt

critical expression

sarcastic expression

expression of evaluating someone's statement

It would be nice if we could do that, but...

そうできればいいんだけど...

sou dekireba ii n da kedo...

It would be nice if we could do that, but...

Variants

- そうできればいいんだけど。

It would be nice if we could do that, but...

- そうできるといいんだけど。

It would be great if we could do that, but...

- そうできたらいいんだけど。

That would be nice if we could, but...

Adjusted Expression

そうできればよいのですが、

It would be good if we could do that, but...

Example

A 「この^{じゅんばん}順番、^い入れ替^かえた方が、^{ほう}効率^{こうりつ}よくないですか？」 B 「そうできればいいんだけど、この^ひ日はまだ^{ざいりょう}材料^{とど}が届いてなくてね」

A: Wouldn't it be more efficient if we switched the order? B: It would be nice if we could do that, but the materials won't have arrived by that day.

Notes

"It would be nice if we could do that, but..." is used when the speaker accepts the listener's suggestion or a desirable plan for the moment,

while indicating that it is difficult to carry it out as stated. "Sou" takes up the method or proposal just mentioned. "Dekireba ii" shows that it would be desirable if that could be done, but "n da kedo" leaves room for a constraint or problem to follow. The expression therefore works as a soft rejection: the speaker does not immediately deny the suggestion, but first acknowledges it as a good ideal and then moves to the reason it may not be possible.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- receiving the listener's suggestion
- introduction of a difficulty in carrying it out
- presentation of wish and constraint
- soft rejection

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- wish expression
- constraint-introducing expression
- soft rejection expression
- expression of receiving a suggestion

It's completely specialized in ...

...に^{かんぜん}完全に^{とっか}特化してる。

... ni kanzen ni tokka shiteru.

It's completely specialized in ...

Variants

- ...に^{かんぜん}完全に^{とっか}特化してる。

It's completely specialized in ...

- ...に^{とっか}特化してる。

It's specialized in ...

- ...のためだけに^{つく}作られている。

It's made just for ...

Adjusted Expression

...に^{かんぜん}完全に^{とっか}特化しています。

It is completely specialized in ...

Example

この^{さいと}サイトはこの^{ぶんや}分野に^{かんぜん}完全に^{とっか}特化してるから、^{ほか}他のことはあまり^{せつめい}説明して
ないんだよね。

This site is completely specialized in this field, so it doesn't explain much about other things.

Notes

"It's completely specialized in ..." is used to explain that an object, service, site, tool, or system is strongly focused on a particular field, purpose, or use. "Tokka shiteru" indicates that it is not designed to cover many things broadly, but is made or operated with a specific target in mind. With "kanzen ni," the narrowing of focus sounds quite thorough. The expression can therefore be used both positively, meaning that something has a high degree of specialization, and negatively, meaning that it has little general-purpose flexibility.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

explanation of limited use

evaluation of specialization

clarification of the target range

expression of strong focus

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

explanation expression

specialization expression

expression of limited use

focusing expression

On a related note, ...

ちなみに、...

chinamini, ...

On a related note, ...

Variants

- ちなみに、...

On a related note, ...

- ちなみにね、...

By the way, ...

- ちなみにさ、...

This is related, but...

Adjusted Expression

すこ かんれん はなし
少し関連する話ですが、...

This is somewhat related, but...

Example

A 「きょう ばれんたいんでー今日はバレンタインデーですね」 B 「そうですね。ちなみに、もう
ちょこ かチョコ、買いました？」

A: Today is Valentine's Day, isn't it? B: Yes, it is. On a related note, have you bought chocolate yet?

Notes

"On a related note" is used when the speaker adds information that is somewhat connected to the previous topic. It may look like a topic-

shifting expression, but it sounds unnatural if the new topic is completely unrelated. The expression works because there is at least some connection to what was just said. Therefore, "chinamini" is not a signal for starting an unrelated topic. It is a signal for adding related information, a related question, or a small supplementary point to the previous topic. "Chinamini ne" and "chinamini sa" are more casual forms that lightly hand additional information to the listener.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- addition of related information
- presentation of supplementary information
- adding something to the previous topic
- light development of the conversation

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- expression for adding related information
- supplementary expression
- topic-connecting expression
- light topic-development expression

Any good way to do it?

なに ほうほう
何かいい方法は？

nanika ii houhou wa?

Any good way to do it?

Variants

- なに ほうほう
• 何かいい方法は？

Any good way to do it?

- なに ほうほう
• 何かいい方法ある？

Is there any good way to do it?

- なに ほうほう
• 何かいい方法ない？

Do you have any good ideas?

- なに かた
• 何かいいやり方は？

Any good approach?

Adjusted Expression

なに よ ほうほう
何か良い方法がありますか？

Is there any good way to do it?

Example

この問題、どうにかしたいんだけど、なに ほうほう
何かいい方法は？

I want to do something about this problem. Any good way to do it?

Notes

"Any good way to do it?" is used when the speaker asks the listener for a solution, method, or way forward in response to a problem or difficult situation. The speaker stops after "nanika ii houhou wa" without saying "arimasu ka," leaving room for the listener to offer an idea. Although it looks unfinished as a sentence, it works fully in conversation as a question meaning "Is there any good way?" Because it is short, it lets the speaker consult the listener lightly without stopping the flow of conversation. "Nanika ii houhou aru?" directly asks whether there is a good method, while "nanika ii houhou nai?" sounds a little more like the speaker is stuck and looking for help.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

asking for a method

asking for a solution

consulting the listener

questioning through an unfinished sentence

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

method-question expression

solution-seeking expression

consultation expression

unfinished sentence

I have to go now.

もう、行^いかなくっちゃ。

mou, ikanakuccha.

I have to go now.

Variants

- もう、行^いかなくっちゃ。
I have to go now.
- もう、行^いかなきゃ。
I gotta go now.
- そろそろ行^いかなくっちゃ。
I should get going.

Adjusted Expression

もう、行^いかなくてはなりません。

I have to go now.

Example

もう、行^いかなくっちゃ。次^{つぎ}の予^よ定^{てい}があるからね。

I have to go now. I have another appointment.

Notes

"I have to go now" is a casual expression used when the speaker has to leave the current place or situation. "Mou" shows that the time has already reached that point, and "ikanakuccha" is a casual form of

"ikanakute wa," expressing the need to go. However, the expression is not merely an explanation of obligation. It tells the listener that the speaker is about to leave or move on, while also prompting the speaker themselves to actually go. It therefore works naturally as an entry into leave-taking or moving to the next place.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- stating that one has to leave
- sharing time pressure
- telling oneself to move
- transition toward leaving

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- necessity expression
- time-pressure expression
- leave-taking expression
- self-prompting expression

Can you hear me?

き
聞こえる？

kikoeru?

Can you hear me?

Variants

- き
聞こえる？

Can you hear me?

- き
聞こえてる？

Can you hear me now?

- こえ き
声、聞こえる？

Can you hear my voice?

Adjusted Expression

わたし こえ き
私の声が聞こえますか？

Can you hear my voice?

Example

A 「もしもし、き
聞こえる？」 B 「うん、き
聞こえてるよ」

A: Hello, can you hear me? B: Yes, I can hear you.

Notes

"Can you hear me?" is used on the phone or in an online meeting to check whether the listener can hear the speaker's voice. It is not simply a question about the listener's hearing ability. It checks whether the audio,

connection, and channel for conversation are working. "Kikoeteru?" more strongly suggests checking whether the voice is reaching the listener continuously at the present moment. The expression is used immediately before entering the main conversation, to confirm that the connection with the listener has been established.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- checking audio
- checking the connection
- checking before starting conversation
- checking whether one's voice reaches the listener

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- confirmation expression
- audio-checking expression
- connection-checking expression
- conversation-starting expression

I hope it goes well.

うまくいくといいね。

umaku iku to ii ne.

I hope it goes well.

Variants

- うまくいくといいね。

I hope it goes well.

- うまくいくといいな。

Hope it goes well.

- うまくいくといいですね。

I hope everything works out.

Adjusted Expression

うまくいくといいですね。

I hope it goes well.

Example

A 「明日^{あした}の試験^{しけん}、大丈夫^{だいじょうぶ}かな？」 B 「うまくいくといいね」

A: Do you think I'll be okay on tomorrow's exam? B: I hope it goes well.

Notes

"I hope it goes well" is used when the listener is about to face an exam, presentation, job, plan, or other upcoming event, and the speaker wishes for a good result. "Umaku iku" means that things proceed smoothly and turn out well. "To ii ne" shares the speaker's wish with the listener.

Rather than strongly pushing or encouraging the listener, the expression gently receives the listener's anxiety or expectation and adds the hope that things will move in a good direction.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of hoping for a good result
- light support for the listener
- receiving the listener's anxiety
- sharing of feeling

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- wish expression
- support expression
- expression of receiving anxiety
- feeling-sharing expression

Is this wrong?

これってまちが
間違ってる？

kore tte machigatteru?

Is this wrong?

Variants

- これってまちが
間違ってる？

Is this wrong?

- これってまちが
間違い？

Is this a mistake?

- これ、まちが
間違ってるかな？

Do you think this is wrong?

Adjusted Expression

これはまちが
間違っていますか？

Is this wrong?

Example

これってまちが
間違ってる？ せいかい
おも
正解だと思っただけど、...

Is this wrong? I thought it was correct, but...

Notes

"Is this wrong?" is used when the speaker checks with the listener whether an answer, expression, method, or other item in front of them is correct. "Kore tte" lightly presents the target of confirmation as the topic.

"Machigatteru?" asks whether it may be wrong. The expression is not only a simple correctness check. It can also carry the feeling "I thought this was right, but now I'm not sure." It therefore works as an entry point for handing the judgment to the listener and possibly correcting one's own answer or method.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- checking correctness
- presentation of uncertainty about one's own judgment
- request for confirmation from the listener
- entry point for self-correction

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- confirmation expression
- correctness-checking expression
- expression of doubt
- self-correction expression

Be bad at it

うで わる
腕が悪い

ude ga warui

Be bad at it

Variants

- 腕が悪い
be bad at it
- 腕がいい
be good at it
- 腕がない
have no skill

Adjusted Expression

かれ さぎょう じゅうぶん ぎじゅつ
彼は、その作業を十分にこなす技術がない。

He does not have the skill to perform that task adequately.

Example

A 「このパチンコ台、全然入らないね」 B 「うで わる 腕が悪いんだよ」

A: This pachinko machine doesn't work at all. B: You don't have the skill for it.

Notes

The phrase "ude ga warui" refers to a lack of skill or ability. In a comedy sketch by Leonardo Kuma, a man says, "What's wrong with this pachinko

machine? It doesn't go in at all," and is told, "It's not the machine, it's your skill that's bad." He then goes to a doctor and says, "Doctor, please do something about it." This shows how an evaluation can be reinterpreted as a physical problem, creating a mismatch in meaning.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- evaluating ability
- pointing out skill level
- light criticism

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- idiomatic expression
- colloquial
- ability evaluation
- skill

I'll be right back.

すぐ、^{もど}戻る。

sugu, modoru.

I'll be right back.

Variants

- すぐ、^{もど}戻る。

I'll be right back.

- すぐに^{もど}戻る。

I'll return soon.

- すぐ^{もど}戻ってくる。

I'll come right back.

Adjusted Expression

すぐに^{もど}戻ります。

I will be right back.

Example

ちょっと、いい？ すぐ、^{もど}戻るから。

Hey, I'll be right back, okay?

Notes

'Sugu, modoru.' is a colloquial expression used when briefly leaving a place. It does not explicitly state the subject or tense, but it is fully

understood in context. It functions to reassure the other person that the speaker will return soon.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of temporary departure
- sharing that the speaker will return soon
- presentation of reassurance to the listener
- brief announcement of action

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- temporary departure expression
- reassurance sharing expression
- action-announcing expression
- short response

Hey, are you free tomorrow?

あのね、^あ明日、^あ空いてる？

ano ne, ashita, aiteru?

Hey, are you free tomorrow?

Variants

- あのね、^あ明日、^あ空いてる？

Hey, are you free tomorrow?

- あのさ、^あ明日、^あ空いてる？

Hey, do you have time tomorrow?

- ^あ明日、^あ空いてる？

Are you free tomorrow?

Adjusted Expression

すみません、^あ明日は、^{つごう}ご都合いかがでしょうか？

Excuse me, are you available tomorrow?

Example

A 「あのね、^あ明日、^あ空いてる？」 B 「ちょっと、^{よてい}予定があるけど」

A: Hey, are you free tomorrow? B: I have some plans, but...

Notes

'Ano ne, ashita, aiteru?' is a colloquial expression used to casually check someone's schedule for tomorrow, typically when talking to friends or

close acquaintances. 'Ano ne' is a phrase used to get someone's attention, and 'aiteru?' means 'are you free?'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- checking someone's schedule
- prelude to an invitation
- addressing someone familiar
- checking the listener's availability

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- schedule-confirmation expression
- familiarity-sharing expression
- invitation-introducing expression
- availability-checking expression

I'm about to go home.

いま かえ
今、帰るところ。

ima, kaeru tokoro.

I'm about to go home.

Variants

- いま かえ
今、帰るところ。

I'm about to go home.

- いま かえ
今、帰るところ。

I'm just about to head home.

- いま かえ
今から帰るところ。

I'm about to leave for home now.

Adjusted Expression

いま かえ
今、帰るところです。

I am just about to go home.

Example

しごと お
仕事が終わって、いま かえ
今、帰るところ。

My work is finished, and I'm just about to go home.

Notes

'Ima, kaeru tokoro.' is a colloquial expression used to briefly convey the current situation. 'Ima' means 'right now', and 'kaeru tokoro' means

'about to go home'. It is used when you want to let someone know that you are about to head home after finishing work or other tasks.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of current situation

sharing of upcoming action

report before starting to move

notifying the listener of one's situation

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

current situation expression

action-sharing expression

pre-departure report expression

situation-notifying expression

Is this all?

これで^{ぜんぶ}全部？

kore de zenbu?

Is this all?

Variants

- これで^{ぜんぶ}全部？

Is this all?

- これで、^{ぜんぶ}全部？

Is this everything?

- これで、すべて？

Is that everything?

Adjusted Expression

これで^{ぜんぶ}全部ですか？

Is this all?

Example

A 「これで^{ぜんぶ}全部？」 B 「そうだよ。^{ぜんぶ}全部、^{くるま}車に^つ積んだよ」

A: Is this all? B: Yes, I loaded everything into the car.

Notes

'Kore de, zenbu?' is a colloquial expression used to check whether the situation is complete at this point. 'Kore de' marks a boundary or cutoff,

and 'zenbu?' asks whether that is all, often with a slight sense of surprise or mismatch with expectation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- checking completion
- checking quantity or scope
- expression of slight surprise
- checking a stopping point in the task

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- confirmation expression
- completion-checking expression
- scope-checking expression
- expression of slight surprise

I haven't decided yet.

まだ^き決めてない。

mada kimetenai.

I haven't decided yet.

Variants

- まだ^き決めてない。

I haven't decided yet.

- まだ^き決まってるない。

It hasn't been decided yet.

- まだ^き決めてないんだよね。

I haven't made up my mind yet.

Adjusted Expression

まだ^き決めていません。

I haven't decided yet.

Example

A 「^{しゅうまつ}週末の^{よてい}予定は？」 B 「まだ^き決めてないんだよね」

A: What are your plans for the weekend? B: I haven't decided yet.

Notes

'Mada kimetenai' is a colloquial expression used when it is already understood that a decision is expected, and the speaker indicates that

they have not reached that point yet. 'Mada' marks that the process is still ongoing, and 'kimetenai' shows that the result has not been reached.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of undecidedness
- sharing of situation
- presentation of pending judgment
- explanation that the decision has not yet been made

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- expression of undecidedness
- expression of situation sharing
- pending-judgment expression
- pre-decision expression

Is this mine?

これ、^{わたし}私の？

kore, watashi no?

Is this mine?

Variants

- これ、^{わたし}私の？

Is this mine?

- これ、^{わたし}私のもの？

Is this my thing?

- これって、^{わたし}私の？

Is this supposed to be mine?

Adjusted Expression

これは^{わたし}私のものでしょうか？

Is this mine?

Example

A 「これ、^{わたし}私の？」 B 「いいや、^{ぼく}僕の」

A: Is this mine? B: No, it's mine.

Notes

'Kore, watashi no?' is a colloquial expression used to confirm whether something in front of you belongs to you. It often carries a sense of surprise or confusion. 'Kore' means 'this', and 'watashi no' means 'mine'.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- confirmation of ownership
- checking who something in front of the speaker belongs to
- sharing of surprise
- expression of confusion

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- expression of ownership confirmation
- expression of checking belonging
- expression of surprise sharing
- expression of confusion

Ah, I'm on the train now.

ああ、^{いま}今、^{でんしゃ}電車。

aa, ima, densha.

Ah, I'm on the train now.

Variants

- ああ、^{いま}今、^{でんしゃ}電車。

Ah, I'm on the train now.

- ああ、^{いま}今、^{でんしゃ}電車の^のに乗ってる。

Ah, I'm currently on the train.

- ^{いま}今、^{でんしゃ}電車。

I'm on the train now.

Adjusted Expression

^{いま}今、^{でんしゃ}電車の^のに乗っています。

I'm currently on the train.

Example

A 「どこにいる？」 B 「ああ、^{いま}今、^{でんしゃ}電車」

A: Where are you? B: Ah, I'm on the train now.

Notes

'Ah, ima, densha.' is a colloquial expression used to briefly convey the current situation. 'Ah' is an interjection that expresses surprise or realization, 'ima' means 'right now', and 'densha' means 'train'. For

example, when you are on the phone with a friend, you can say this to let them know where you are at the moment.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of current situation

sharing of location

presentation of situation as a response

brief explanation of current location

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

current situation expression

location-sharing expression

short response

expression with an unexpressed particle

Could you help me a little?

ちょっと、^{てっだ}手伝ってもらえる？

chotto, tetsudatte moraeru?

Could you help me a little?

Variants

- ちょっと、^{てっだ}手伝ってもらえる？
Could you help me a little?
- ちょっと、^{てっだ}手伝ってくれる？
Can you give me a hand?
- ちょっと、^{てっだ}手伝ってもらっていい？
Could I get a little help?

Adjusted Expression

^{すこ}少し、^{てっだ}手伝っていただけますか？

Could you please help me a little?

Example

A 「この^{にもつ}荷物、^{おも}重いんだけど、ちょっと、^{てっだ}手伝ってもらえる？」 B 「もちろん！どこに^{はこ}運ぶの？」

A: This luggage is heavy. Could you help me a little? B: Of course! Where should I carry it?

Notes

'Chotto, tetsudatte moraeru?' is a colloquial expression used when the speaker wants the listener to help a little. 'Chotto' means 'a little,' and 'tetsudatte moraeru?' means 'Could you help me?' A more polite form would be 'Sukoshi, tetsudatte itadakemasu ka?', but in casual conversation, this shorter form is often used.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of asking for help

request to the listener

request for light cooperation

casual request expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

expression of asking for help

request expression

cooperation-request expression

colloquial expression

It's not that easy.

そんなに簡単じゃないよ。

sonna ni kantan ja nai yo.

It's not that easy.

Variants

- そんなに簡単じゃないよ。
It's not that easy.
- そんなに簡単じゃないんだよ。
It's not that simple.
- そんな簡単な話じゃないよ。
It's not as simple as that.

Adjusted Expression

それはそんなに簡単ではありません。

That is not that easy.

Example

A 「この問題、簡単だね！」 B 「うーん、そんなに簡単じゃないよ」

A: This problem is easy! B: Well, it's not that easy.

Notes

'Sonna ni kantan ja nai yo' is a colloquial expression used to convey that something is more difficult than expected. 'Sonna ni' means 'that much', and 'kantan ja nai' means 'not easy'. For example, when someone says

that a certain task or problem is easy, and you feel that their perception is too optimistic, you might respond with this phrase.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of difficulty level
- correction of the listener's expectation
- sharing of reality
- mild disagreement

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- difficulty level expression
- reality sharing expression
- mild disagreement expression
- expectation-correcting expression

I'm just looking.

み
見てるだけ。

miteru dake.

I'm just looking.

Variants

- み
見てるだけ。

I'm just looking.

- み
見てるだけだよ。

I'm just observing.

- ちょっとみ
見てるだけ。

I'm only looking around.

Adjusted Expression

ただみ
見ているだけです。

I'm just looking.

Example

A 「これ、ほしいの？」 B 「いや、み
見てるだけだよ」

A: Do you want this? B: No, I'm just looking.

Notes

'Miteru dake' is a colloquial expression used to say that you are only looking and not actively doing anything else. 'Dake' limits the action to looking, and suggests that there is no further intention or action. It can

be used when browsing items in a shop or when someone asks what you are doing.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of situation
- sharing of observation
- denial of intention to buy
- presentation that there is no further intention

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- situation expression
- observation sharing expression
- expression of denying intention to buy
- limiting expression

Everyone is doing it.

みんな、やってるよ。

minna, yatteru yo.

Everyone is doing it.

Variants

- みんな、やってるよ。
Everyone is doing it.
- みんな、やっているよ。
Everybody does it.
- みんな、やってるじゃん。
Everyone else is doing it.

Adjusted Expression

みんな、やっているんですよ。

Everyone is doing it.

Example

A 「こんな変なことしちゃだめ！」 B 「えーっ、みんな、やってるよ」

A: You shouldn't do such a weird thing! B: What? Everyone is doing it.

Notes

'Minna, yatteru yo.' is a colloquial expression used to say that a certain behavior is common or normal among people around the speaker. Here, 'minna' does not necessarily mean literally everyone. It is used to suggest that many people do it, that the speaker is not the only one, or that the

behavior is generally accepted. For this reason, it can also be used to lightly justify one's own behavior or to push back against the listener's criticism.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of common behavior
- social justification
- presentation that the speaker is not the only one
- response against the listener's criticism

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- expression of common behavior
- social sharing expression
- justification expression
- counterargument expression

It would be nice if I could do it, but...

できるとうれしいけど。

dekiru to ureshii kedo.

It would be nice if I could do it, but...

Variants

- できるとうれしいけど。

It would be nice if I could do it, but...

- できるといいんだけど。

It would be great if I could do it, but...

- できたらうれしいんだけど。

I'd be happy if I could do it, but...

Adjusted Expression

できるとうれしいのですが。

It would be nice if I could do it, but...

Example

この仕事^{しごと}、できるとうれしいけど、ちょっと難^{むづか}しいかもね。

It would be nice if I could do this job, but it might be a little difficult.

Notes

'Dekiru to ureshii kedo' is a colloquial expression used to express a desire that something would be possible. 'Dekiru to' means 'if I can do it', and 'ureshii kedo' means 'I would be happy, but...'. When talking about taking

on a challenge or discussing possibilities, you can say this to convey a modest hope.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of desire
- sharing of modest hope
- reservation about feasibility
- hope with an implied difficulty

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- expression of desire
- modest hope sharing expression
- expression of reservation about feasibility
- colloquial expression

What should I bring?

なに も
何、持ってけばいい？

nani, mottekeba ii?

What should I bring?

Variants

- なに も
何、持ってけばいい？

What should I bring?

- なに も
何を持っていけばいい？

What do I need to bring?

- なに も
何、持っていけばいいかな？

What should I take with me?

Adjusted Expression

なに も
何を持っていけばいいですか？

What should I bring?

Example

A 「あす びく にっ く なに も
明日のピクニック、何、持ってけばいい？」 B 「うーん、のみもの おかし
飲み物とお菓子
があれば」

A: What should I bring for tomorrow's picnic? B: Hmm, drinks and snacks would be good.

Notes

'Nani, mottekeba ii?' is a colloquial expression used to ask what items are needed for a certain event or gathering. 'Nani' means 'what', and 'mottekeba' means 'should bring'. For example, when discussing preparations for a picnic or party with friends, you can ask this to confirm what items are necessary.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

question expression

checking preparation

checking necessary items

asking the listener for judgment

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

question expression

preparation-checking expression

necessary-item-checking expression

expression with an unexpressed particle

I'm glad I was able to do it.

できて、うれしい。

dekite, ureshii.

I'm glad I was able to do it.

Variants

- できて、うれしい。
I'm glad I was able to do it.
- できるようになって、うれしい。
I'm happy I can do it now.
- できて、よかった。
I'm glad it worked out.

Adjusted Expression

できるようになって、うれしく^{おも}います。

I am glad that I am now able to do it.

Example

^{あたら}新しい^{しごと}仕事^ができて、うれしい。

I'm glad I was able to do the new job.

Notes

'Dekite, ureshii' is a colloquial expression used to express joy about being able to do something. 'Dekite' means 'can/could do', and 'ureshii' means 'glad'. For example, when you acquire a new skill or start a new job, you can say this to convey your happiness about having that ability.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of joy at achievement
- joy at gaining ability
- sharing of a result
- expression of positive feeling

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- ability expression
- achievement expression
- joy sharing expression
- result-sharing expression

I'm in trouble.

こま
困^{こま}っちゃった。

komacchatta.

I'm in trouble.

Variants

- 困^{こま}っちゃった。

I'm in trouble.

- どうしよう。

What should I do?

- 困^{こま}ったな。

I'm stuck.

Adjusted Expression

こま
困^{こま}ってしまいました。

I'm in trouble.

Example

A 「子供^{こども}が泣^なき止^やまなくて、困^{こま}っちゃった」

A: My child won't stop crying, and I'm in trouble.

Notes

'Komacchatta' is a colloquial expression used to convey that you are facing a problem or difficult situation. 'Komaru' means 'to be troubled', and 'cchatta' indicates that the speaker has ended up in that troubled

state. For example, when you are struggling to finish your homework or when an unexpected problem arises, you can say this to express your confusion and desire for help.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of difficulty
- sharing of being in trouble
- presentation of a wish for help
- expression of not knowing what to do

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- expression of difficulty
- expression of confusion
- expression of seeking help
- result-state expression

Alright, let's do it!

よし、やるか！

yoshi, yaru ka!

Alright, let's do it!

Variants

- よし、やるか！
Alright, let's do it!
- よし、やろう！
Okay, let's go!
- よし、始めるか！
Alright, let's get started!

Adjusted Expression

さあ、^{はじ}始めましょう！

Alright, let's get started!

Example

A 「^{じゅんび}準備、できた？」 B 「うん、よし、やるか！」

A: Are you ready? B: Yeah, alright, let's do it!

Notes

'Yoshi, yaru ka!' is a colloquial expression used to motivate oneself or others before starting something. 'Yoshi' means 'alright', and 'yaru ka' means 'let's do it'. For example, before a sports game or the start of a

project, saying this can help boost the atmosphere and encourage everyone to get ready for action.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of starting action
- self-prompting
- sharing of motivation
- switching the situation into action

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- action-starting expression
- self-prompting expression
- motivation-sharing expression
- scene-shifting expression

Don't rush.

あせ だ
焦っちゃ駄めだよ。

aseccha dame da yo.

Don't rush.

Variants

- あせ だ
● 焦っちゃ駄めだよ。

Don't rush.

- あせ
● 焦らないでね。

Don't get flustered.

- あせ
● 焦っちゃだめ。

Stay calm.

Adjusted Expression

あせ
焦らないでください。

Please don't rush.

Example

しけん ちか あせ だ
試験が近いからって、焦っちゃ駄めだよ。

Just because the exam is coming up, don't rush things.

Notes

'Asecha dame da yo' is a colloquial expression used to tell someone not to get flustered or rush into things. 'Aseru' means 'to get impatient' or 'to panic', and 'ccha dame' is a casual prohibitive form meaning 'don't do

that'. For example, when an exam or project deadline is approaching, you can say this to encourage someone to stay calm. This is a line spoken by Professor Keizo Itsuki in episode 11 of the first season of the anime Moyashimon. In the episode, the line appears as 'I told you, don't rush.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of caution
- encouraging calmness
- warning against disturbed judgment
- encouragement of the listener

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- caution expression
- calmness-sharing expression
- prohibitive expression
- encouragement expression

Why don't you just try it?

とにかくやってみたら。

tonikaku yatte mitara.

Why don't you just try it?

Variants

- とにかくやってみたら。
Why don't you just try it?
- とりあえずやってみたら。
Just give it a try.
- まずやってみたら。
Why not try it first?

Adjusted Expression

とにかくやってみてください。

Please just try it.

Example

あたら新しいことを始めるのは怖いけど、とにかくやってみたら？

Starting something new can be scary, but why don't you just give it a try?

Notes

'Tonikaku yatte mitara' is a colloquial expression used to encourage someone who is hesitating to start something to try taking action first. 'Tonikaku' means 'anyway,' and 'yatte mitara' means 'why don't you try it?' For example, when someone feels anxious about starting a new

hobby or taking on a new job, you can say this to suggest the importance of trying first.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- encouragement of action
- advice to someone who is hesitating
- suggestion to try
- interruption of overthinking

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- action-encouraging expression
- trial-suggesting expression
- advice expression
- expression of interrupting hesitation

Are you ready?

じゅんび
準備、できた？

junbi, dekita?

Are you ready?

Variants

- じゅんび
準備、できた？

Are you ready?

- じゅんび
準備はできた？

Are you all set?

- もうじゅんび
準備できた？

Have you finished getting ready?

Adjusted Expression

じゅんび
準備はできましたか？

Have you finished getting ready?

Example

A 「じゅんび
準備、できた？」 B 「まだ、できてない」

A: Are you ready? B: Not yet.

Notes

'Junbi, dekita?' is a colloquial expression used to check whether someone is ready before starting something. 'Junbi' means 'preparation', and 'dekita?' asks whether that preparation has been completed. Compared

with 'Junbi wa dekita?', the form 'Junbi, dekita?' sounds more immediate, as if the speaker is checking the listener's state in the moment.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- confirmation of readiness
- checking before starting an action
- checking the listener's state
- prompting action

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- readiness confirmation expression
- action-prompting expression
- state-checking expression
- expression with an unexpressed particle

Those two get along well, don't they?

あのふたり、^{なか}仲いいね。

ano futari, naka ii ne.

Those two get along well, don't they?

Variants

- あのふたり、^{なか}仲いいね。

Those two get along well, don't they?

- あの^{ふたり}二人、^{なか}仲いいね。

Those two seem to have a good relationship.

- あの^{ふたり}二人は、^{なか}仲がいいですね。

Those two are close, aren't they?

Adjusted Expression

あの^{ふたり}二人は、^{なか}仲がいいですね。

Those two seem to have a good relationship, don't they?

Example

A 「あの^{ふたり}二人、^{なか}仲いいね」 B 「そうね、^{きょうだい}兄弟みたい」

A: Those two get along well, don't they? B: Yes, they do. They seem like siblings.

Notes

'Ano futari, naka ii ne.' is a colloquial expression used to point to two people who are present or being talked about, and to share the

observation that they have a good relationship. 'Ano' points to the people in question, 'futari' treats them as a pair, and 'naka ii ne' is a casual form of 'naka ga ii desu ne', used to share the speaker's judgment in the moment.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of relationship
- sharing of observation
- expression of seeing two people as a pair
- casual evaluation

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- relationship expression
- shared observation expression
- colloquial expression
- expression with an unexpressed particle

Tastes amazing!

げき う ま
激ウマ！

geki uma!

Tastes amazing!

Variants

- げき う ま
● 激ウマ！

Tastes amazing!

- めっちゃ^{う ま}ウマイ！

This is so delicious!

- げき ま ず
● 激マズ！

Tastes terrible!

Adjusted Expression

これはとても^{おい}美味しいですね！

This tastes really good!

Example

A「このラーメン、^{げき う ま}激ウマ！」 B「うそー、^{げき ま ず}激マズ！」 A「そんなこと言っちゃだめだよ、^{てんいん}店員さんに聞こえるよ」

A: This ramen tastes amazing! B: No way, it tastes terrible! A: Don't say that, the staff can hear you.

Notes

'Geki uma!' is a colloquial expression used to describe food or drink that tastes extremely delicious. 'Geki' means 'extremely', and 'uma' is a casual way of saying 'delicious'. On the other hand, 'Geki mazu!' is a colloquial expression used to describe food or drink that tastes extremely bad, where 'mazu' means 'bad tasting'.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of taste

sharing of strong evaluation

sharing of excitement

colloquial reaction

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

taste expression

emphatic expression

excitement sharing expression

colloquial expression

Sorry I'm late.

おく
遅れてごめん。

okurete gomen.

Sorry I'm late.

Variants

- おく
遅れてごめん。

Sorry I'm late.

- おく
遅れてすみません。

Sorry for being late.

- おく
遅くなってごめん。

I apologize for being late.

Adjusted Expression

おく
遅れてすみません。

I apologize for being late.

Example

A 「おく
遅れてごめん！」 B 「だいじょうぶ ぼく いま き
大丈夫、僕も今、来たところ」

A: Sorry I'm late! B: It's okay, I just got here too.

Notes

'Okurete gomen' is a colloquial expression used to apologize immediately when you arrive late for an appointment or meeting. 'Okurete' indicates that the speaker has arrived after the expected time, and 'gomen'

expresses an apology for causing trouble or making the other person wait. It is an immediate reaction often used with people the speaker is close to.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of apology
- arrival-time reaction
- apology for making someone wait
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- apology expression
- arrival-time reaction expression
- meeting-up expression
- colloquial expression

I'm a little busy right now.

いま 今、 ちょっと、 いそが 忙しくて。

ima, chotto, isogashikute.

I'm a little busy right now.

Variants

- いま 今、 ちょっと、 いそが 忙しくて。

I'm a little busy right now.

- いま すこ いそが 今、 少し忙しくて。

I'm a bit busy at the moment.

- いま いそが ちょっと今、 忙しくて。

I'm a little tied up right now.

Adjusted Expression

いま すこ いそが 今、 少し忙しいんです。

I am a little busy right now.

Example

A 「いま 今、 ちょっと、 いそが 忙しくて」 B 「わかった、あとでいいよ」

A: I'm a little busy right now. B: Okay, later is fine.

Notes

'Ima, chotto, isogashikute.' is a colloquial expression used to gently say that the speaker is busy right now and cannot respond immediately. 'Ima' marks the current situation, and 'chotto' softens both the degree of

busyness and the refusal. 'Isogashikute' would normally lead to a following reason or result, but here the sentence stops there, allowing the listener to understand that the speaker is occupied and wants to postpone the matter.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of situation
- expression of delayed response
- soft refusal
- request to postpone

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- situation expression
- delayed-response expression
- soft-refusal expression
- unfinished expression

I have to go home.

かえ
帰んなくっちゃ。

kaennakuccha.

I have to go home.

Variants

- かえ 帰んなくっちゃ。

I have to go home.

- かえ 帰んなくちゃ。

I need to go home.

- かえ 帰らなくちゃ。

I should get going.

Adjusted Expression

かえ
帰らなくてははいけません。

I have to go home.

Example

A 「もう^{おそ}遅いから、^{かえ}帰んなくっちゃ」 B 「うん、^き気をつけてね」

A: It's already late, I have to go home. B: Yeah, take care.

Notes

'Kaennakucha' is a colloquial expression used to say, in a soft and immediate way, that the speaker has to go home. It comes from a shortened casual form of 'kaeranakute wa naranai', meaning 'have to go

home'. It expresses the feeling that the speaker needs to leave soon, and can sound as if the speaker is reminding themselves that it is time to go.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of necessity
- expression of departure
- self-prompting to go home
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- necessity expression
- departure expression
- going-home expression
- self-prompting expression

Sorry, I forgot.

ごめん、^{わす}忘れちゃって。

gomen, wasurechatte.

Sorry, I forgot.

Variants

- ごめん、^{わす}忘れちゃって。
Sorry, I forgot.
- ごめん、^{わす}忘れてた。
Sorry, I forgot about it.
- ごめん、うっかり^{わす}忘れてた。
Sorry, I completely forgot.

Adjusted Expression

^{もうしわけ}申し訳ありません、^{わす}忘れてしまいました。

I apologize. I forgot about it.

Example

A 「^{やくそく}約束してたのに、ごめん、^{わす}忘れちゃって」 B 「^{だいじょうぶ}大丈夫だよ、^{つぎ}次は^き気をつけてね」

A: I'm sorry. We had plans, but I forgot. B: It's okay. Just be careful next time.

Notes

'Gomen, wasurechatte' is a colloquial expression used to apologize on the spot for accidentally forgetting an appointment, plan, or something one was supposed to do. 'Gomen' expresses an apology, and 'wasurechatte' is a casual form of 'wasurete shimatte', meaning that the speaker ended up forgetting. Compared with simply saying 'wasureta', it sounds softer and carries a slight sense of accidental mistake or excuse.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of apology

sharing of mistake

explanation of accidental forgetting

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

apology expression

mistake sharing expression

expression of accidental mistake

colloquial expression

I have a quick question.

ちょっと聞^ききたいことあるんだけど、...

chotto kikitai koto aru n dakedo, ...

I have a quick question.

Variants

- ちょっと聞^ききたいことあるんだけど、...

I have a quick question.

- ちょっと聞^ききたいことがあるんだけど、...

I just want to ask something.

- ちょっと聞^ききたいんだけど、...

Can I ask you something?

Adjusted Expression

ちょっとお聞^ききたいことがあるのですが、...

I have a quick question.

Example

A 「ちょっと聞^ききたいことあるんだけど、...」 B 「うん、何^{なに}？」

A: I have a quick question. B: Yeah, what is it?

Notes

'Chotto kikitai koto arun dakedo,...' is a way to enter a question softly. By stopping at 'dakedo', the speaker leaves space for the listener to accept the question.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of question introduction
- expression of initiating talk
- expression of waiting for the listener's response
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- question-introduction expression
- talk-initiating expression
- unfinished expression
- listener-consideration expression

Could you pass that to me?

それ^と取ってもらえる？

sore totte moraeru?

Could you pass that to me?

Variants

- それ^と取ってもらえる？

Could you pass that to me?

- それ^と取ってくれる？

Can you pass that to me?

- それ^と取って？

Could you get that for me?

Adjusted Expression

それ^とを取っていただけますか？

Could you please pass that to me?

Example

A 「ちょっと、それ^と取ってもらえる？」 B 「うん、いいよ」

A: Could you pass that to me? B: Yeah, sure.

Notes

'Sore totte moraeru?' is a casual request used when asking someone to pick up or pass something near them. 'Sore' points to an object shared by

gaze or situation. The speaker does not need to name the item, and that is where the immediacy of the expression appears.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of request
- sharing of passing an item
- request to get something nearby
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- request expression
- item-passing sharing expression
- shared-reference expression
- colloquial expression

I always use my calculator

でんたく つか
いつも電卓を使います

Itsumo dentaku o tsukaimasu

I always use my calculator

Variants

- 以^{でんたく}つも電卓^{つか}を使^{つか}います

I always use my calculator

- 電卓^{でんたく}を使^{つか}います

I use my calculator

- 以^{でんたく}つも電卓^{けいさん}で計算^{けいさん}します

With my calculator

- 計算機^{けいさんき}を使^{つか}います

Of course, I use a calculator

- もちろん、電卓^{でんたく}です

I calculate it with a calculator

- 難^{むずか}しい問題^{もんだい}が出^でます

Difficult questions will be on it

- 大^{だいじ}事^{もんだい}な問題^でが出^でます

Important questions will be on it

Adjusted Expression

A「最終^{さいしゅうせいせき}成績^{せいき}は、どのような割合^{わりあい}で計算^{けいさん}するのですか」 B「出席^{しゅっせき}、授業点^{じゅぎょうてん}、宿題^{しゅくだい}、最終試験^{さいしゅうしけん}を一定^{いってい}の割合^{わりあい}で合計^{ごうけい}して計算^{けいさん}します」

A: How will the final grade be calculated? B: It will be calculated by combining attendance, class performance, homework, and the final exam according to fixed proportions.

Example

A 「どんな問題が試験に出るんですか」 B 「難しい問題が出ます」 A 「では、どのように計算するんですか」 B 「もちろん、いつも電卓を使います」

A: What kind of questions will be on the exam? B: Difficult questions will be on it. A: Then how are you going to calculate? B: Oh, yes. I always use my calculator.

Notes

This entry records a classroom exchange that actually took place in English, but it is presented here with Japanese and English counterparts. The student first asks what kind of questions will be on the exam. The teacher answers, "Difficult questions will be on it." Formally, this is an answer, but it does not reveal the actual contents of the exam. The student then asks, "How are you going to calculate?" The intended meaning is about the grading formula: what proportions of attendance, class performance, homework, and the final exam will be used to calculate the final grade. The student is asking about the evaluation system, not the tool used for calculation. The teacher answers, "I always use my calculator." This is a joking literal response. It shifts the focus from the grading formula to the physical tool used for calculation. Both responses formally answer the questions, but pragmatically they avoid giving the specific information the student is seeking. The immediate quality lies in noticing the wording of the student's question and replying through a literal or overly general reinterpretation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- literal response
- avoiding a direct answer
- joking
- focus shift
- classroom management

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- literal response
- avoiding a direct answer
- joking
- focus shift
- teacher talk
- classroom discourse

Can I come in?

はい
入っていい？

haitte ii?

Can I come in?

Variants

- はい
入っていい？

Can I come in?

- はい
入ってもいい？

Is it okay if I come in?

- はい
入ってもいいですか？

May I come in?

Adjusted Expression

いま はい
今、入ってもよろしいでしょうか。

May I come in now?

Example

ねえ、いま はい
今、入っていい？

Hey, can I come in now?

Notes

'Haitte ii?' is used before entering a room or someone else's space. The speaker is outside the boundary and asks whether entering is acceptable.

Although short, it works as an immediate check before crossing into the listener's space.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of permission to enter
- boundary-checking expression
- consideration for the listener's space
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- permission-to-enter expression
- boundary-checking expression
- listener-consideration expression
- colloquial expression

Um, what was it again?

えーと、^{なん}何だっけ？

eeto, nan dakke?

Um, what was it again?

Variants

- えーと、^{なん}何だっけ？

Um, what was it again?

- えーと、^{なん}何だったっけ？

Um, what was it?

- えーと、^{なん}何だっけな？

Um, what was that again?

Adjusted Expression

すみません、ちょっと^{おも}思い出せないんですが、^{なん}何でしたか？

Sorry, I can't recall at the moment, but what was it?

Example

A「この^{たんご}単語、^{いみ}意味わかる？」 B「えーと、^{なん}何だっけ？」 A「ほら、さっき^{せつめい}説明したやつ」 B「ああ、そうだった！ありがとう！」

A: Do you know the meaning of this word? B: Um, what was it again? A: You know, the one I just explained. B: Oh, right! Thanks!

Notes

'Eeto, nan da kke?' keeps the conversation going while the speaker is trying to remember something. It does not simply mean that the speaker does not know the answer. It shows a state of almost remembering and leaves room for the listener to offer a hint.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of recall

buying time to think

expression that invites a hint from the listener

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

recall expression

thinking-time expression

hint-inviting expression

colloquial expression

I used to live in Kyoto.

いぜん きょうと す
以前、京都に住んでたんですよ。

izen, kyoto ni sundeta n desu yo.

I used to live in Kyoto.

Variants

- いぜん きょうと す
• 以前、京都に住んでたんですよ。

I used to live in Kyoto.

- まえ きょうと す
• 前に京都に住んでたんです。

I lived in Kyoto before.

- むかし きょうと す
• 昔、京都に住んでたんですよ。

I used to live in Kyoto, actually.

Adjusted Expression

いぜん きょうと す
以前、京都に住んでいました。

I used to live in Kyoto.

Example

A 「きょうと くわ 京都に詳しいんですね」 B 「ええ、いぜん きょうと す 以前、京都に住んでたんですよ」

A: You know a lot about Kyoto. B: Yes, I used to live in Kyoto.

Notes

'Izen, Kyoto ni sundeta n desu yo.' is used to bring up a past living experience naturally in conversation. 'Sundeta n desu yo' does more than report a fact; it also gives background, as in 'That's why I know a little

about it.' Shared places or experiences can also help reduce the social distance between speakers.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of past experience
- presentation of background information
- sharing of common experience
- expression that reduces conversational distance

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- past-experience expression
- background-information expression
- shared-experience expression
- colloquial expression

Do I really have to do it?

やらずくぢゃなんない？

yaranakucha nannai?

Do I really have to do it?

Variants

- やらずくぢゃなんない？
Do I really have to do it?
- やらなきゃいけないの？
Do I have to do it?
- やらなきゃダメ？
Do I need to do it?

Adjusted Expression

(これを)やらずくてはいけませんか？

Do I have to do this?

Example

A 「この仕事^{しごと}、やらずくぢゃなんない？」 B 「うん、やらないといけないよ」

A: Do I really have to do this work? B: Yeah, you have to do it.

Notes

'Yaranakucha nannai?' is a casual way to ask whether something has to be done. It is not just a neutral question; it can also carry a slight reluctance, as in 'Do I really have to do it?'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- confirmation of necessity
- expression of slight reluctance
- hesitation toward an obligation
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- necessity-confirmation expression
- slight-reluctance expression
- obligation-checking expression
- hesitation expression

That's what it is, but...

そういうことなんだけどね。

sou iu koto nan dakedo ne.

That's what it is, but...

Variants

- そういうことなんだけどね。
That's what it is, but...
- そういうことなんだけど。
That's how it is, but...
- そういうことなんだけどさ。
That's the case, but...
- そういうことなんですけどね。

Adjusted Expression

そういうことなのですが、...

That is how it is, but...

Example

A 「え？じゃ、^{こんご}今後、^{こうえん}公園に^{いぬ}犬を^つ連れて^き来ちゃだめってこと？」 B 「うん、
^{やくしょ}役所の^{せつめい}説明では、そういうことなんだけどね」 A 「えー、^{ねこ}猫が^{かって}勝手に^く来るのは
^よ良くて、^{いぬ}犬は^{だめ}ダメって！」 B 「そうだよ、わかるけどね...」

A: Wait, so does that mean we can't bring dogs to the park anymore? B:
Yeah, according to the city office's explanation, that's how it is, but... A:

What? Cats can just come in on their own, but my dog is not allowed? B: I know, I get it, but...

Notes

'Sou iu koto nan dakedo ne.' is used when the speaker accepts that the explanation is correct, but does not fully accept it emotionally. By stopping at 'dakedo ne', the speaker leaves an unsaid continuation such as 'but it feels strange' or 'but it is still a problem.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of explanation
- expression of leaving something implied
- sharing of incomplete acceptance
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- explanation expression
- implication-leaving expression
- unfinished expression
- incomplete-acceptance expression

Come to think of it, ...

そういやあ、...

sou iyaa, ...

Come to think of it, ...

Variants

- そういやあ、...
Come to think of it, ...
- そういえば、...
Speaking of which, ...
- そういえばね、...
Now that you mention it, ...

Adjusted Expression

そういえば、...

Come to think of it, ...

Example

A 「最近^{さいきん}、あんまり猫^{ねこ}見ないね」 B 「そういやあ、いつも来^きてたのにね」

A: I haven't seen many cats around lately. B: Come to think of it, they used to come all the time, didn't they?

Notes

'Sou iya a,...' is a casual expression used when something related comes to mind after hearing what the other person said. It is a more casual

form of 'sou ieba' and connects the current topic to a new realization rather than making a complete topic shift.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of recall
- expression of association
- realization triggered by the listener's remark
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- recall expression
- association expression
- realization expression
- topic-connecting expression

There may be some mistakes, so...

まちが
間違っていることがあるので、...

machigatte iru koto ga aru node, ...

There may be some mistakes, so...

Variants

- まちが
間違っていることがあるので、...
There may be some mistakes, so...
- まちが
間違いがあるかもしれないので、...
There might be some errors, so...
- まちが
間違いがあるかもしれないから、...
Since there may be mistakes, ...

Adjusted Expression

まちが
間違っていることがあるかもしれませんので、...

There may be some mistakes, so...

Example

A 「まちが
間違っていることがあるので、参考程度さんこうていどにして聞きいてください」

A: There may be some mistakes, so please treat this as a rough reference.

Notes

'Machigatte iru koto ga aru node,...' is used as a preface when the speaker does not want their explanation or material to be taken as final. The

speaker presents the information while also asking the listener to treat it only as a reference.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of qualified presentation
- expression of caution
- specifying how the information should be received
- presentation that the information is not final

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- qualified-presentation expression
- caution expression
- reception-guiding expression
- non-final-information expression

You did a great job to get this far.

よくもここまでがんばったね。

Yokumo koko made ganbatta ne.

You did a great job to get this far.

Variants

- よくもここまでがんばったね。
You did a great job to get this far.
- よくここまでがんばったね。
You really worked hard to get here.
- ここまでがんばったね。
You made it this far, good job.

Adjusted Expression

ほんとう
本当によくここまでがんばりましたね。

You really did a great job to get this far.

Example

A 「毎日、休まずに、学校に行ったよ」 B 「よくもここまでがんばったね」

A: I went to school every day without taking a break. B: You did a great job to get this far.

Notes

'Yokumo koko made ganbatta ne.' is a colloquial expression used to praise someone's effort and perseverance. It is especially used when acknowledging that someone has put in a long time or great effort to

achieve something. It carries a nuance of appreciating the person's hard work and encouraging them. Of course, you could also say 'Yoku koko made ganbatta ne' without the 'mo', and it would have the same meaning, but the version with 'mo' is more colloquial and gives a more friendly feel.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- praise for effort
- expression of encouragement
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- effort-praise expression
- encouragement expression
- colloquial expression

Would it be possible to do something like...?

...とかできないですか？

... toka dekinai desu ka?

Would it be possible to do something like...?

Variants

- ...とかできないですか？

Would it be possible to do something like...?

- ...とかはできないですか？

Isn't it possible to do something like...?

- ...とかは無理ですか？

Would something like ... be impossible?

Adjusted Expression

このカーテンの色をもう少し明るくするなどには可能でしょうか。

Would it be possible to make the color of this curtain a little brighter, for example?

Example

これ、色を明るくするとかできないですか？

Would it be possible to make this color brighter or something like that?

Notes

'...toka dekinai desu ka?' is used to ask about a possible option without making a direct demand. 'Toka' keeps the proposal somewhat open, and 'dekinai desu ka?' leaves room for the listener to judge whether it is

possible. It can be used when asking about an adjustment, a discount, or an alternative.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of suggestion
- confirmation of possibility
- expression that avoids a direct demand
- leaving the judgment to the listener

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- suggestion expression
- possibility-confirmation expression
- indirect request expression
- softening expression

I've been using it for a long time.

ずっと、^{つか}使ってる。

Zutto, tsukatteru.

I've been using it for a long time.

Variants

- ずっと、使ってる。

I've been using it for a long time.

- ずっと、使っています。

I've been using it.

- ずっと、使っているんです。

I've been using it, you know.

Adjusted Expression

これをずっと、^{つか}使っています。

I have been using this for a long time.

Example

あ、これこれ、あのね、これ、^{がくせいじだい}学生時代からずっと、^{つか}使ってる。

Oh, this one. I've had this since I was a student. I still use it.

Notes

'Zutto, tsukatteru.' does not simply mean that the speaker has used something every day without interruption. Even if there were times when it was not used, the speaker can still say this if the item has stayed

with them from the past and is still something they use. It expresses that the relationship with the item has not been broken.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of continued use
- expression of attachment
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- continued-use expression
- attachment expression
- colloquial expression

It won't turn on anymore.

つかなくなってる。

tsukanaku natteru.

It won't turn on anymore.

Variants

- あ、つかなくなってる。
Oh, it won't turn on anymore.
- あ、つかない。
Oh, it won't turn on.
- ^{うご}動かなくなってる。
Oh, it's not working anymore.

Adjusted Expression

^ぱ^そ^こ^ん ^{でんげん} ^{はい}
パソコンの電源が入らなくなっています。

The computer no longer turns on.

Example

あ、^ぱ^そ^こ^んパソコン、つかなくなってる。

Oh, the computer won't turn on anymore.

Notes

'A, pasokon, tsukanaku natteru.' is used when the speaker notices that the computer no longer turns on or the screen no longer lights up.

'Tsuku/tsukanai' is still naturally used with devices such as computers and smartphones.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- discovery of malfunction
- discovery of a change in state
- expression of surprise
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- malfunction-discovery expression
- state-change expression
- surprise expression
- activation element

It's about time to eat lunch.

そろそろ、お^おひ^ひる、食^たべなくちゃね。

Sorosoro, ohiru, tabenakucha ne.

It's about time to eat lunch.

Variants

- そろそろ、お昼、食べなくちゃね。

It's about time to eat lunch.

- そろそろ、お昼、食べないとね。

It's about time for lunch, isn't it?

- そろそろ、お昼にしないとね。

We should probably eat lunch soon.

Adjusted Expression

そろそろ^{ちゅうしょく}昼 食をとみましょう。

It is about time to have lunch.

Example

A 「もう12時^じだね」 B 「そろそろ、お^おひ^ひる、食^たべなくちゃね」

A: It's already noon. B: It's about time for lunch, isn't it?

Notes

'Sorosoro, ohiru, tabenakucha ne.' is used when the speaker notices that it is about time for lunch and gently moves themselves and the listener

toward eating. Here, 'ohiru' means lunch rather than noon, and the final 'ne' shares that timing with the listener.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- awareness of time
- encouragement of action
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- time-awareness expression
- action-encouragement expression
- colloquial expression

It might be possible, you know.

...かもしれませんしね。

... kamoshiremasen shi ne.

That might be the case too.

Variants

- ...かもしれませんしね。
It might be possible, you know.
- ...かもしれないしね。
It could be possible, you know.
- ...かもしれないですしね。
That might be the case too.

Adjusted Expression

...かもしれませんね。

It might be possible.

Example

この問題^{もんだい}、難^{むづか}しいけど、解決策^{かいけつさく}はあるかもしれませんしね。

This problem is difficult, but there might be a solution, you know.

Notes

'...kamoshiremasen shi ne.' presents a possibility as one option left open. With 'shi ne', the speaker does not make a firm claim, but leaves room for the listener to share the sense that such a possibility may also exist.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- presentation of possibility
- expression of leaving room
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- possibility-presentation expression
- room-leaving expression
- colloquial expression

That's not what I mean, though.

そういう意味ではないんですけどね。

sou iu imi de wa nai n desu kedo ne.

That's not what I mean, though.

Variants

- そういう意味ではないんですけどね。

That's not what I mean, though.

- そういう意味じゃないんだけどね。

That's not what I meant, though.

- そういう意味じゃないんですけどね。

That's not the meaning, though.

Adjusted Expression

そういう意味ではありませんが、...

That is not what I mean, but...

Example

A 「それって、彼のことが嫌いってこと？」 B 「いや、そういう意味ではないんですけどね」

A: Does that mean you dislike him? B: No, that's not what I mean, though.

Notes

'Sou iu imi de wa nain desu kedo ne.' is used when the speaker feels that the listener has misunderstood what they said, and they want to correct

that misunderstanding while still leaving some implication rather than fully explaining. Variations such as 'sou iu imi ja nai n da kedo ne' and 'sou iu imi ja nai n desu kedo ne' also exist, and all of them carry a colloquial nuance.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- correction of misunderstanding
- expression of leaving something implied
- expression of holding back a full explanation
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- misunderstanding-correction expression
- implication-leaving expression
- colloquial expression

Totally fine.

ぜんぜん^あり^り。

Zenzen ari.

Totally fine.

Variants

- ぜんぜん^あり^り。

Totally fine.

- ぜんぜん^あり^り 全然^{ぜんぜん}ア^あリ^りですね。

Completely acceptable.

- ぜんぜんありますよ。

Totally okay.

Adjusted Expression

それはぜんぜん^{ぜんぜんもんだい}問題ありません。

(That is) totally fine.

Example

A 「この絵、お店の雰囲気^{え みせ ふん い き}に合う？」 B 「ぜんぜん^あり^りですよ」

A: Does this picture fit the atmosphere of the store? B: Totally fine.

Notes

'Zenzen ari.' is a casual expression used to affirm something that the other person may be unsure about. Here, 'zenzen' strengthens a positive

judgment rather than a negative one. 'Ari' means that something is acceptable, works well enough, or is a valid option.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of affirmation
- expression of easing concern
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- affirmation expression
- concern-easing expression
- colloquial expression

Does it have to be something I really want to make?

ほんとう つく もの だめ
本当に作りたい物じゃないとダメ？

hontou ni tsukuritai mono ja nai to dame?

Does it have to be something I really want to make?

Variants

- ほんとう つく もの だめ
本当に作りたい物じゃないとダメなの？

Does it have to be something I really want to make?

- ほんとう つく もの だめ
本当に作りたいものでないとダメ？

Does it really have to be something I want to make?

- ほんとう つく もの だめ
本当に作りたいものじゃないといけない？

Do I have to make something I really want to make?

Adjusted Expression

ほんとう つく もの
本当に作りたい物でなければいけませんか？

Do I have to make something that I really want to make?

Example

ほんとう つく もの だめ
本当に作りたい物じゃないとダメ？

Does it have to be something I really want to make?

Notes

'Hontou ni tsukuritai mono ja nai to dame?' is used when the speaker questions a condition or standard set by someone else: 'Does it really

have to be that?' The form 'ja nai to dame?' expresses hesitation or slight resistance before accepting the condition.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- confirmation of condition
- confusion about the standard
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- condition-confirmation expression
- standard-confusion expression
- colloquial expression

Isn't this a really detailed task?

めっちゃめっちゃ、^{こま}細かい^{さぎょう}作業じゃないですか、これは。

Mechamecha, komakai sagyou janai desu ka, kore wa.

Isn't this a really detailed task?

Variants

- めっちゃめっちゃ、^{こま}細かい^{さぎょう}作業じゃないですか。

Isn't this a really detailed task?

- めっちゃ^{こま}細かい^{さぎょう}作業じゃないですか。

Isn't this an extremely detailed task?

- めちゃくちゃ、^{こま}細かい^{さぎょう}作業じゃないですか。

Isn't this super detailed?

Adjusted Expression

これはとても^{こま}細かい^{さぎょう}作業ですね。

This is a very detailed task.

Example

A 「めっちゃめっちゃ、^{こま}細かい^{さぎょう}作業じゃないですか、これは」 B 「そうですね、
^{たしか}確かに細かいですね」

A: Isn't this a really detailed task? B: Yeah, it really is.

Notes

'Mechamecha, komakai sagyou janai desu ka, kore wa.' expresses surprise at how detailed the task is and invites the listener to share that reaction. 'Mechamecha' intensifies the degree, 'janai desu ka' seeks agreement, and the final 'kore wa' points back to the task itself.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

emphasis on detail

expression of surprise

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

detail-emphasis expression

surprise expression

colloquial expression

Day by day.

ひ ひ
日に日に。

Hi ni hi ni.

Day by day.

Variants

- ひ ひ
日に日に。

Day by day.

- ひ
日ごとに。

With each passing day.

- だんだん。

Gradually.

Adjusted Expression

ひ ひ じょうきょう へん か
日に日に、状況が変化しています。

The situation is changing day by day.

Example

同じじゃないんだよ。ひ ひ か じょうきょう
日に日に、変わってるんだよ、状況は。

It's not the same. Day by day, the situation is changing.

Notes

'Hi ni hi ni' expresses change that accumulates as the days pass. It does not simply mean 'every day'; it suggests that the situation is no longer the same as before and is gradually changing day by day.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of passage of time
- expression of change
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- time-passage expression
- change expression
- colloquial expression

It seems hopeless.

だめ
ダメっぽい(ね)。

dameppoi ne.

It doesn't look good.

Variants

- だめ
• ダメっぽいね。

It seems hopeless.

- だめ
• ダメっぽいな。

It looks like it's not going to work.

- だめ
• ダメっぽいよね。

It seems pretty bad, doesn't it?

Adjusted Expression

じょうきょう わる
状況が悪そうですね。

(The situation) seems bad.

Example

このプロジェクト、予算も時間も足りないし、人手も足りないから、ちょっとダメっぽいね。

This project is short on budget, time, and manpower, so it seems pretty hopeless.

Notes

'Dameppoi ne' is used when the speaker judges from the situation or available information that something probably will not work. Instead of saying 'dame' directly, 'ppoi' leaves some room, and 'ne' shares that view with the listener.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of negative evaluation

expression of bad situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

negative-evaluation expression

bad-situation expression

colloquial expression

A huge help.

おおだす
大助かり！

Oodasukari.

A huge help.

Variants

- おおだす
大助かり。

A huge help.

- ほんとう おおだす
本当に大助かり。

Really a huge help.

- おおだす
すごく大助かり。

Such a huge help.

Adjusted Expression

ほんとう たす
本当に、助かりました。

Your help is very much appreciated.

Example

A 「おおだす大助かり！」 B 「いえいえ、お役やくに立てよて良かったです」

A: That's a huge help! B: I'm glad I could help.

Notes

'Oodasukari' is used when someone's help greatly reduces a burden or solves a problem. It expresses not only gratitude, but also a sense of relief, as in 'That really helped.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of gratitude
- expression of reduced burden
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- gratitude expression
- burden-reduction expression
- colloquial expression

Ah, you choose first.

あ、^{さき}先に^{えら}選んで？

a, saki ni erande?

Ah, you choose first.

Variants

- あ、^{さき}先に^{えら}選んで？

Ah, you choose first.

- あ、^{さき}先に^{えら}選んでくれる？

Ah, could you choose first?

- あ、^{さき}先に^{えら}選んでいいよ。

Ah, you can choose first.

Adjusted Expression

^あ ^な ^た ^{さき} ^{えら}
あなたが先に選んでください。

Please choose first.

Example

A 「この^{けー} ^きケーキ、どれにする？」 B 「うーん、あ、^{さき}先に^{えら}選んで？」 A 「じゃあ、お^{さき}先に」

A: Which cake do you want? B: Hmm... oh, you choose first. A: Okay, I'll go first.

Notes

'A, saki ni erande?' is used when the speaker lets the other person choose before them. The initial 'a' marks the moment the speaker shifts and gives the choice to the listener, and 'erande?' lightly hands over the turn to choose.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

yielding the choice

consideration for the other person

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

choice-yielding expression

consideration expression

colloquial expression

It does not have to be right away.

あと い
後で良いから。

Ato de ii kara.

It does not have to be right away.

Variants

- 後でいいから。

It does not have to be right away.

- 後で大丈夫だから。

You can do it later.

- 後でいいよ。

Later is fine.

Adjusted Expression

いま だいじょうぶ
今すぐでなくても大丈夫です。

It does not have to be right away.

Example

A 「この仕事、今すぐですか？」 B 「いや、あと い 後で良いから」

A: Do you need this done right away? B: No, it does not have to be right away.

Notes

'Ato de ii kara' tells the listener that they do not need to deal with something right away and helps ease their burden. The final 'kara' works

like a soft reason or reassurance, giving the sense of 'It does not have to be now.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- permission to postpone
- expression of easing burden
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- postponement-permission expression
- burden-easing expression
- colloquial expression

Realistically, assuming you bought it, ...

じっさい か
実際、買ったとして、...

Jissai, katta to shite, ...

Realistically, assuming you bought it, ...

Variants

- 実際、買ったとして、...
Realistically, assuming you bought it, ...
- 実際、買ったとしたら、...
Realistically, if you bought it, ...
- 実際、買ったとすると、...
Realistically, suppose you bought it, ...

Adjusted Expression

げんじつてき こうにゆう ばあい
現実的に、それを購入した場合、...

Realistically, if you bought it, ...

Example

A 「じっさい か実際、買ったとして、お ばしょ こま置き場所、困らない？」 B 「お ばしょああ、置き場所かあ」

A: Realistically, assuming you bought it, wouldn't you have trouble finding a place to put it? B: Ah, space for it, huh.

Notes

'Jissai, katta to shite, ...' accepts the idea of buying something as a hypothesis and then shifts the conversation to realistic issues that would

follow. 'Jissai' moves the focus away from desire or ideal plans and back to concrete conditions such as space, cost, or actual use. B's response, 'Ah, space for it, huh,' does not merely name the issue of space; through the form 'Ah, ... huh,' it shows that the listener is noticing and taking in that condition at that moment.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- presentation of hypothetical
- return to realistic conditions
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- hypothetical-presentation expression
- realistic-condition expression
- colloquial expression

Knowing this may be asking too much, ...

む り しょうち い
無理を承知で言えば、...

Muri o shouchi de ieba, ...

Knowing this may be asking too much, ...

Variants

- 無理を承知で言えば、...

Knowing this may be asking too much, ...

- 無理を承知の上で言えば、...

If I may say this knowing it may be unreasonable, ...

- 無理を承知でお願いすれば、...

If I may ask despite knowing this may be difficult, ...

Adjusted Expression

むづか しょうち
難しいことは承知していますが、...

I understand that this may be difficult, but ...

Example

む り しょうち い しごと あした ねが
無理を承知で言えば、この仕事、明日までにはお願いできませんか。

Knowing this may be asking too much, could I ask you to finish this work by tomorrow?

Notes

'Muri o shouchi de ieba, ...' is used when the speaker first acknowledges that what they are about to say may be difficult or burdensome for the

listener, but still says it. By saying 'muri o shouchi de', the speaker avoids simply imposing the request or opinion and first shows consideration for the listener.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- preface to a difficult request
- anticipation of burden
- expression of consideration

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- difficult-request expression
- burden-anticipation expression
- consideration expression

I know, I know.

^わ
分かってますってば。

Wakatterumasu tte ba.

I know, I know.

Variants

- 分かってますってば。

I know, I know.

- 分かっているってば。

I told you, I know.

- 分かっているよ、もう。

I know already.

Adjusted Expression

^わ
分かっていますよ。

I understand.

Example

A 「もうすぐ晩御飯^{ばんごはん}なんだから、早く^{はや}帰^{かえ}ってきてよ」 B 「^わ分かってますってば」

A: Dinner is soon, so please come home early. B: I know, I know.

Notes

'Wakatterumasu tte ba.' is used to show that the speaker already understands what the other person is explaining or warning about, while

also pushing back slightly. 'Tte ba' adds the feeling of 'I already know, so you don't need to keep saying it.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- statement of understanding
- light pushback to the other person
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- understanding-statement expression
- light-pushback expression
- colloquial expression

Right now, my room is extremely messy, but...

いま さいきょう へ や ち
今、最強に部屋が散らかってるんだけ
ど、...

Ima, saikyou ni heya ga chirakatteru n da kedo, ...

Right now, my room is extremely messy, but...

Variants

- 今、最強に部屋が散らかってるんだけど、...
Right now, my room is extremely messy, but...
- 今、めちゃくちゃ部屋が散らかってるんだけど、...
Right now, my room is super messy, but...
- 今、すごく部屋が散らかってるんだけど、...
Right now, my room is really messy, but...

Adjusted Expression

げんざい へ や ち
現在、部屋がとても散らかっていますが、...

Right now, my room is very messy, but...

Example

A 「いま さいきょう へ や ち ほんとう く いま
今、最強に部屋が散らかってるんだけど、本当にうちに来るの？」 B 「今
なの？いつもじゃなくて？」

A: Right now, my room is extremely messy, but are you really coming over? B: Right now? Not usually?

Notes

'Ima, saikyou ni heya ga chirakatteru n da kedo, ...' is used to warn the listener in advance about the state of the room before they come over. 'Saikyou ni' is a very casual, exaggerated intensifier that makes the mess sound extreme in a slightly playful way. 'N da kedo' makes that condition a premise for what follows. B's response, 'Right now? Not usually?', lightly teases A's implication that the room is only messy right now.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

advance warning about a condition

preface to a visit

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

advance-condition expression

visit-preface expression

colloquial expression

Could it be getting serious?

もしかして、やばいことになってる？

Moshikashite, yabai koto ni natteru?

Could it be getting serious?

Variants

- もしかして、やばいことになってる？
Could it be getting serious?
- もしかして、やばいことになってるんじゃない？
Maybe things are getting bad?
- もしかして、やばいことになってるの？
Is something bad happening?

Adjusted Expression

もしかすると、^{じょうきょう}状況^{わる}が悪くなっているかもしれませんね。

Perhaps the situation may be getting worse.

Example

A 「ねえ、^{けさ}今朝、^{なに}何も^い言わないで、^{いえ}家、^で出てきたでしょ？」 B 「そうだけど、もしかして、やばいことになってる？」

A: Hey, you left the house this morning without saying anything, right? B: Yeah, but could it be getting serious?

Notes

'Moshikashite, yabai koto ni natteru?' is used when the other person's words or behavior suddenly make an alarming possibility come to mind.

'Moshikashite' marks the possibility as still uncertain, and 'yabai koto ni natteru?' checks whether something unspecified but bad may be developing.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- checking an alarming possibility
- expression of concern
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- alarming-possibility-checking expression
- concern expression
- colloquial expression

Oh, the power, huh.

あ、^{でんげん}電源かあ。

A, dengen kaa.

Oh, the power, huh.

Variants

- あ、電源かあ。
Oh, the power, huh.
- あ、電源だったのかあ。
Oh, it was the power.
- あ、電源が原因だったのかあ。
Oh, the power was the cause.

Adjusted Expression

ああ、^{でんげん}電源が^{げんいん}原因だったのか。

Ah, so it was the power.

Example

A 「それって、この^{す い っ ち}スイッチ、^い入れた？」 B 「あ、^{でんげん}電源かあ」

A: Did you turn on this switch? B: Oh, the power, huh.

Notes

'A, dengen kaa.' is used when the speaker notices, on the spot, that the power may be the cause after the other person's prompt. 'A' marks the rise of realization, 'dengen' brings the newly foregrounded cause into

view, and 'kaa' shows that the speaker is taking it in. With just this short chain, it conveys the feeling of 'I had not thought of that' and 'Now I see.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of realization
- receiving a possible cause
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- realization expression
- possible-cause expression
- colloquial expression

Ah, I see.

ああ、そうだったんだ。

Aa, sou dattan da.

Ah, I see.

Variants

- ああ、そうだったんだ。

Ah, I see.

- ああ、そうだったのか。

Ah, so that's how it was.

- ああ、そうだったのね。

Ah, I get it now.

Adjusted Expression

ああ、そうだったんですね。

Ah, I see.

Example

A 「しばらく、^{びょうき}病気してて、^こ来れなくてね」 B 「ああ、そうだったんだ」

A: I was sick for a while, so I couldn't come. B: Ah, I see.

Notes

'Aa, sou dattan da.' is used when the speaker realizes something after hearing the other person's explanation or point. It gives the feeling of 'I had not thought of that' or 'Now I understand.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of realization
- statement of understanding
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- realization expression
- understanding-statement expression
- colloquial expression

I'm not sure about that.

それ、^{びみょう}微妙。

Sore, bimyou.

I'm not sure about that.

Variants

- それ、微妙。

I'm not sure about that.

- それ、ちょっと微妙。

That's iffy.

- それ、微妙かも。

That might be a bit questionable.

Adjusted Expression

それは、あまりよくないかもしれませんね。

That may not be such a good idea.

Example

A 「この^{あいであ}アイデア、どう？」 B 「それ、ちょっと^{びみょう}微妙かも」

A: What do you think of this idea? B: I'm not sure about that.

Notes

'Sore, bimyou.' is used when the speaker does not want to say something is plainly bad, but also cannot support it as it is. It gives a slightly negative reaction in a softened way.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of evaluation
- softened negative response
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- evaluation expression
- softened-negative-response expression
- colloquial expression

You have a unique vibe.

どくとく ふんいき
独特な雰囲気があるね。

Dokutoku na fun'iki ga aru ne.

You have a unique vibe.

Variants

- 独特な雰囲気があるね。

You have a unique vibe.

- 独特な感じがするね。

You have a distinctive feel.

- 独特なオーラがあるね。

You have a unique aura.

Adjusted Expression

どくとく ふんいき も
独特な雰囲気を持っていますね。

You have a distinctive atmosphere.

Example

A 「この服、似合う？」 B 「うーん、独特な雰囲気があるね」

A: Does this outfit suit me? B: Hmm, you have a unique vibe.

Notes

'Dokutoku na fun'iki ga aru ne.' is used to comment on someone's distinctive impression or presence. It can work as a compliment, but it can also sound slightly ambiguous because the speaker is not clearly

saying that something suits the person or is good. In the example, B does not directly say that the outfit suits A, but says that A has a unique vibe.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- evaluation of individuality
- ambiguous compliment
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- individuality-evaluation expression
- ambiguous-compliment expression
- colloquial expression

Colophon

Title	An Expression A Day
Author	Hilofumi Yamamoto, Ph.D.
Range	No. 701-800 / 100 entries
License	Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC BY 4.0)
Source	Generated from AEAD JSON data.